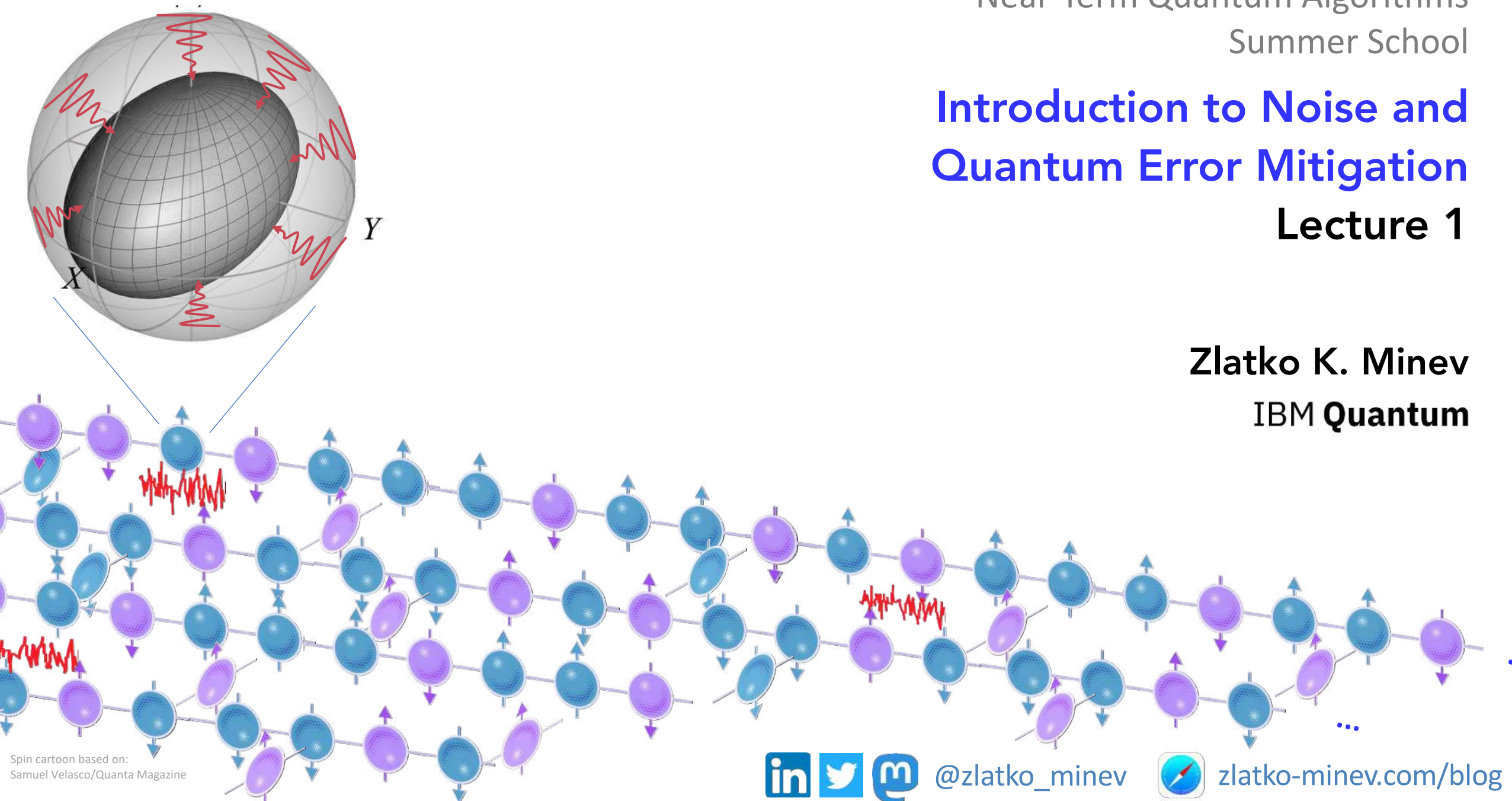


Introduction to Noise and Quantum Error Mitigation

Lecture 1

Zlatko K. Minev
IBM Quantum



Spin cartoon based on:
Samuel Velasco/Quanta Magazine



@zlatko_minev



zlatko-minev.com/blog

Have you used
a quantum computer?



Quantum Noise and Error Mitigation

Lecture 1

Big picture

Quantum computers status

Why error mitigation?

Noise in quantum computers
Overview of error mitigation

Mitigation fundamentals

Probabilistic error cancelation (PEC)

Introduction
One qubit example

Next lecture

Learning noise
State-of-art mitigation experiments
Hardware
Outlook



Where?

Slides from lecture

See school slack

Will also post here zlatko-minev.com/education

Related

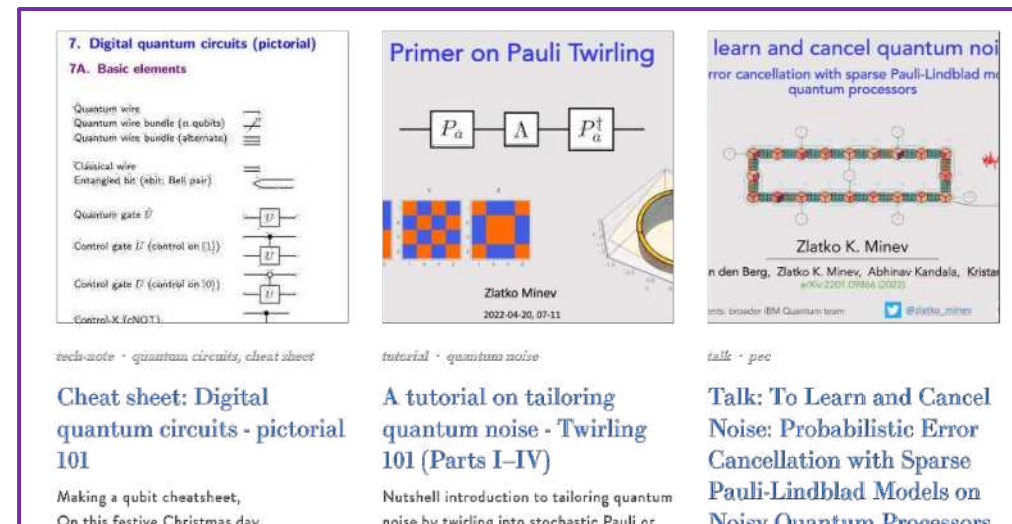
Lectures qiskit.org/learn

Tutorials zlatko-minev.com/blog

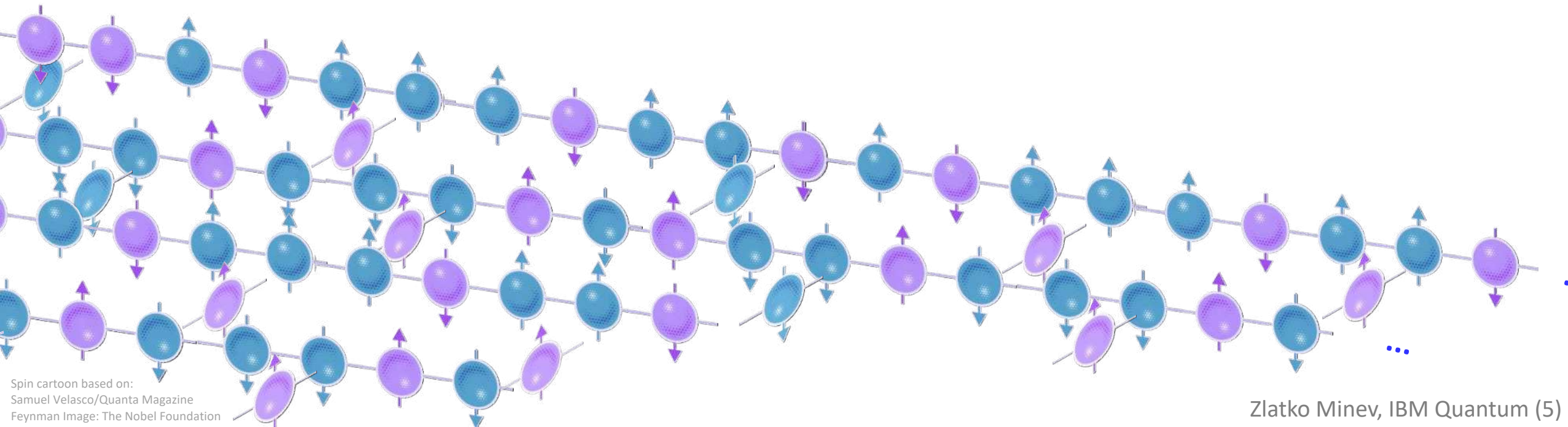
(Twirling, Measurements, Walsh-Hadamard, ...)

Weekly seminars

qiskit.org/events/seminar-series



How is it going for quantum computers?



This year 2023

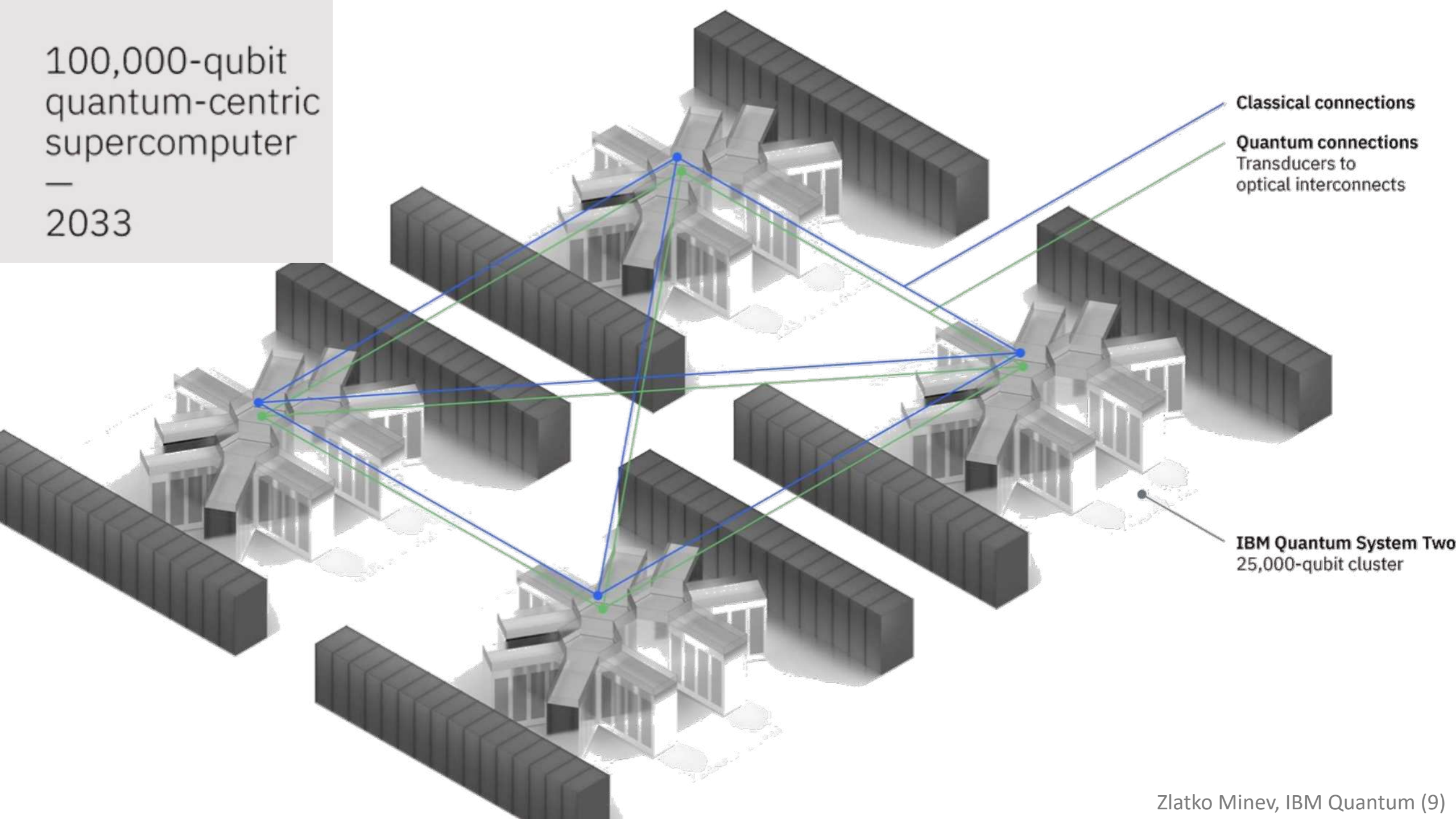
A 127-qubit quantum computer installed in the the lobby cafeteria of a research building dutifully executing jobs almost all the time.







100,000-qubit
quantum-centric
supercomputer
—
2033

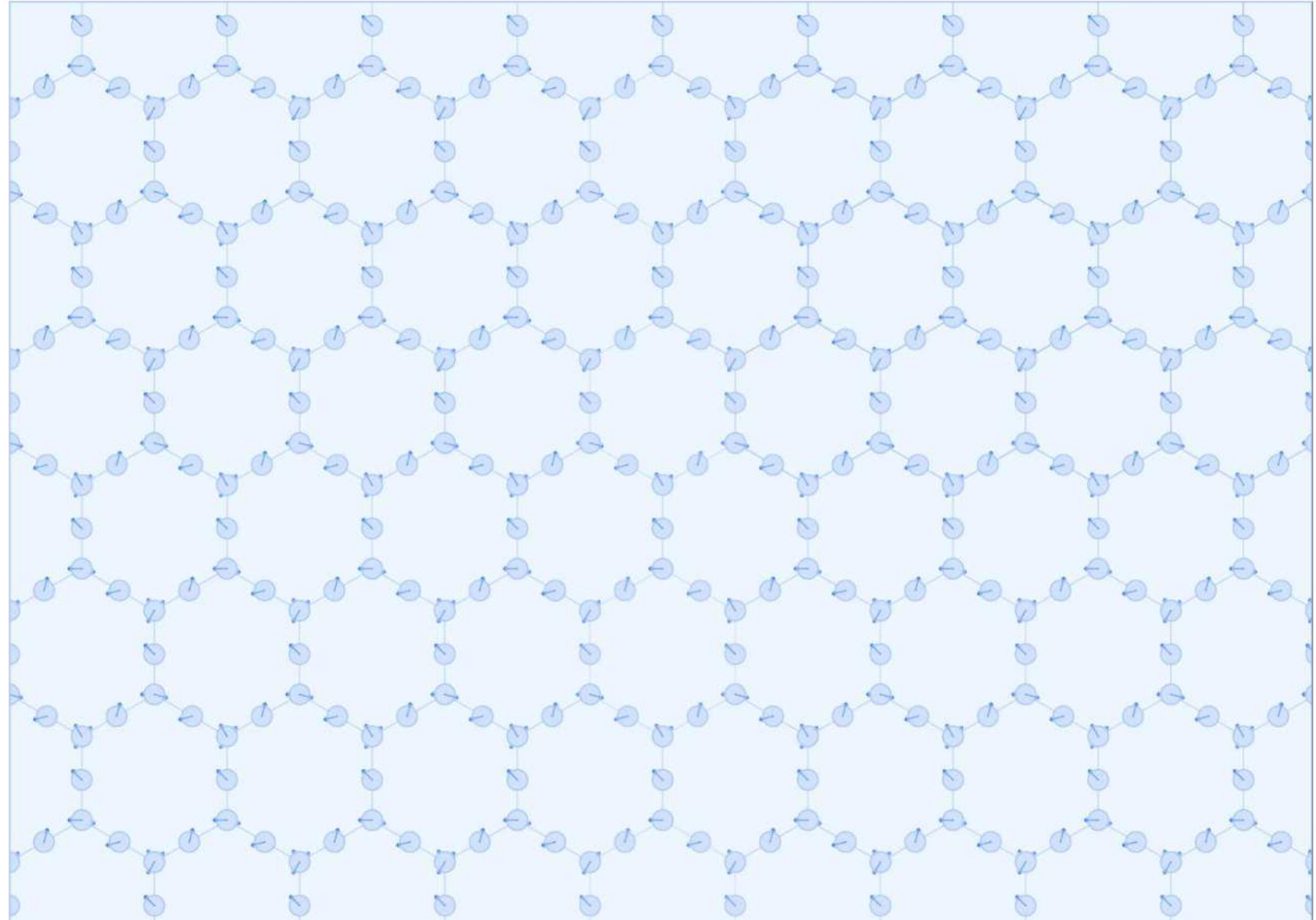


Back to today ...

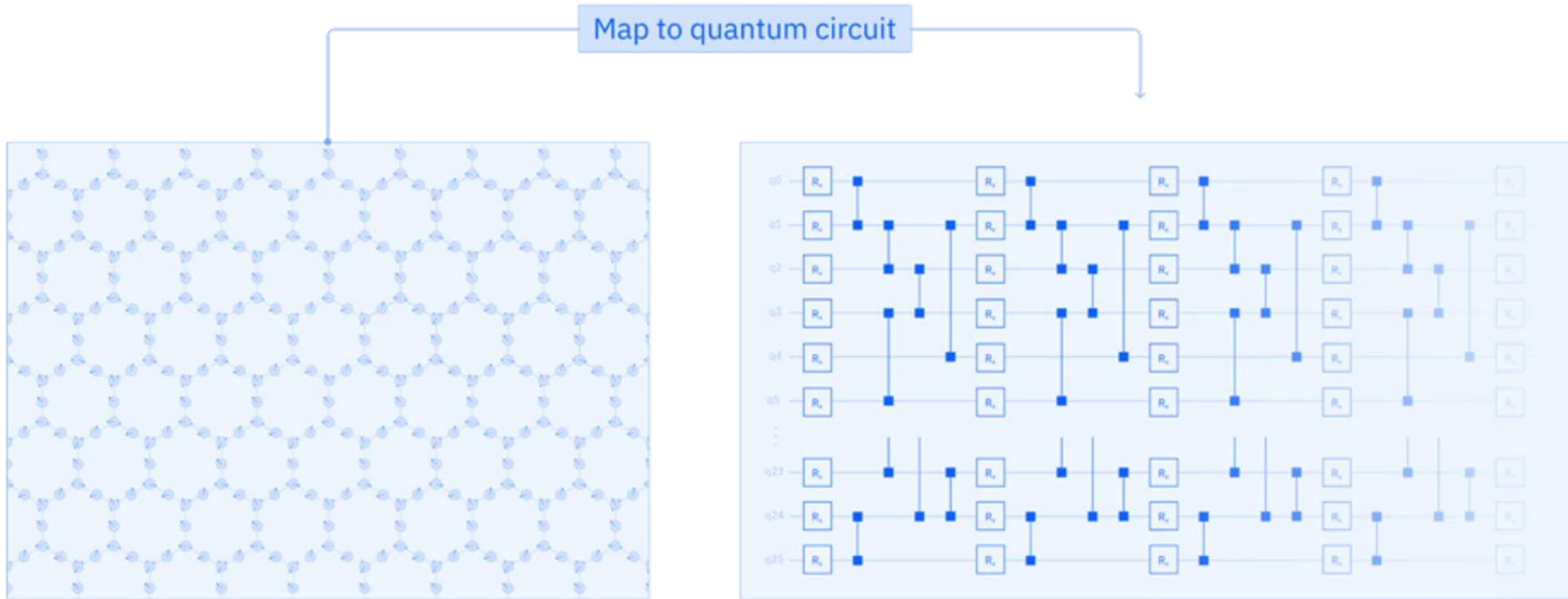
Example: Quantum simulation

Example task:

Simulate the out-of-equilibrium quantum dynamics of a 2D spin chain lattice to find the evolution of the global and local magnetization.

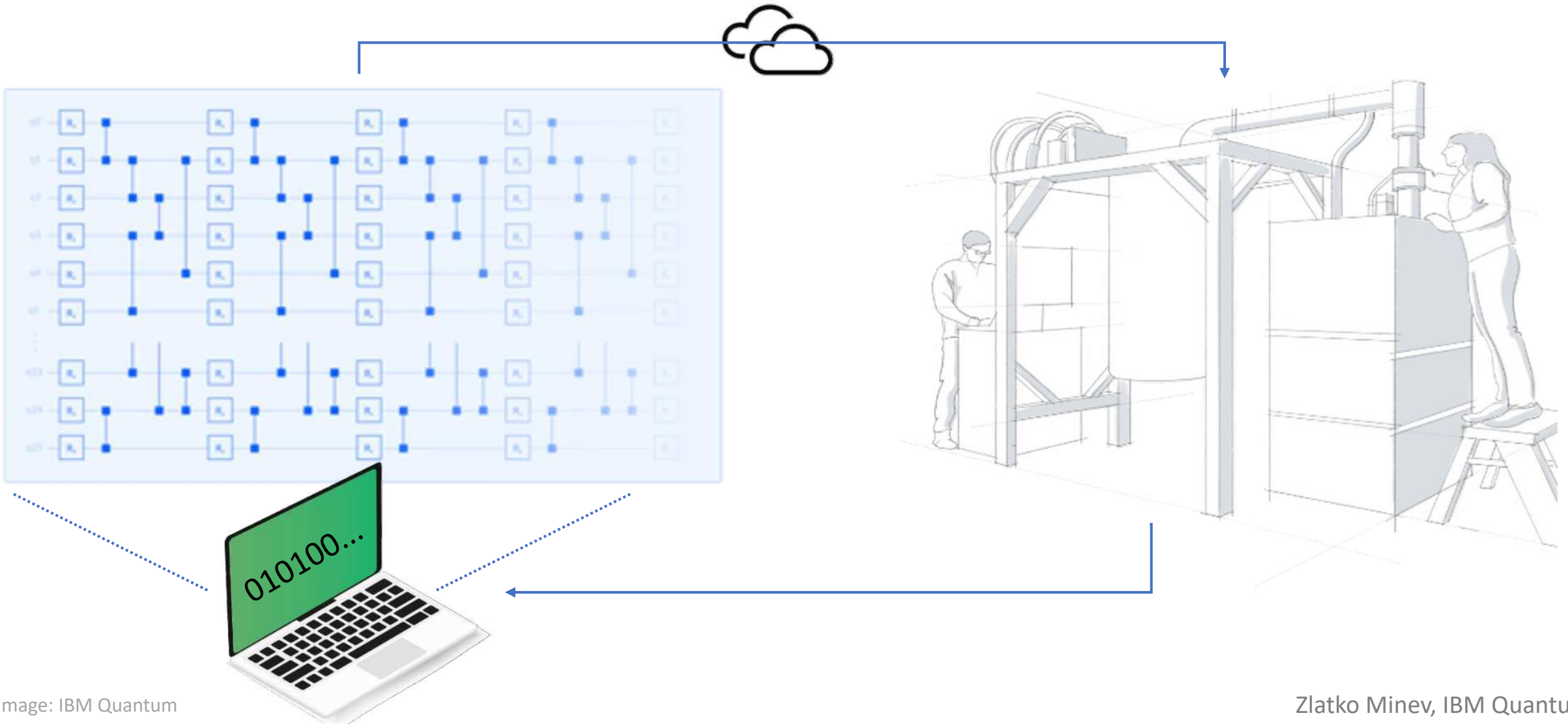


Quantum simulation on a quantum computer



Quantum simulation on a quantum computer

Execute on a real quantum computer device and obtain results as classical data



Biggest challenge?

Please do share



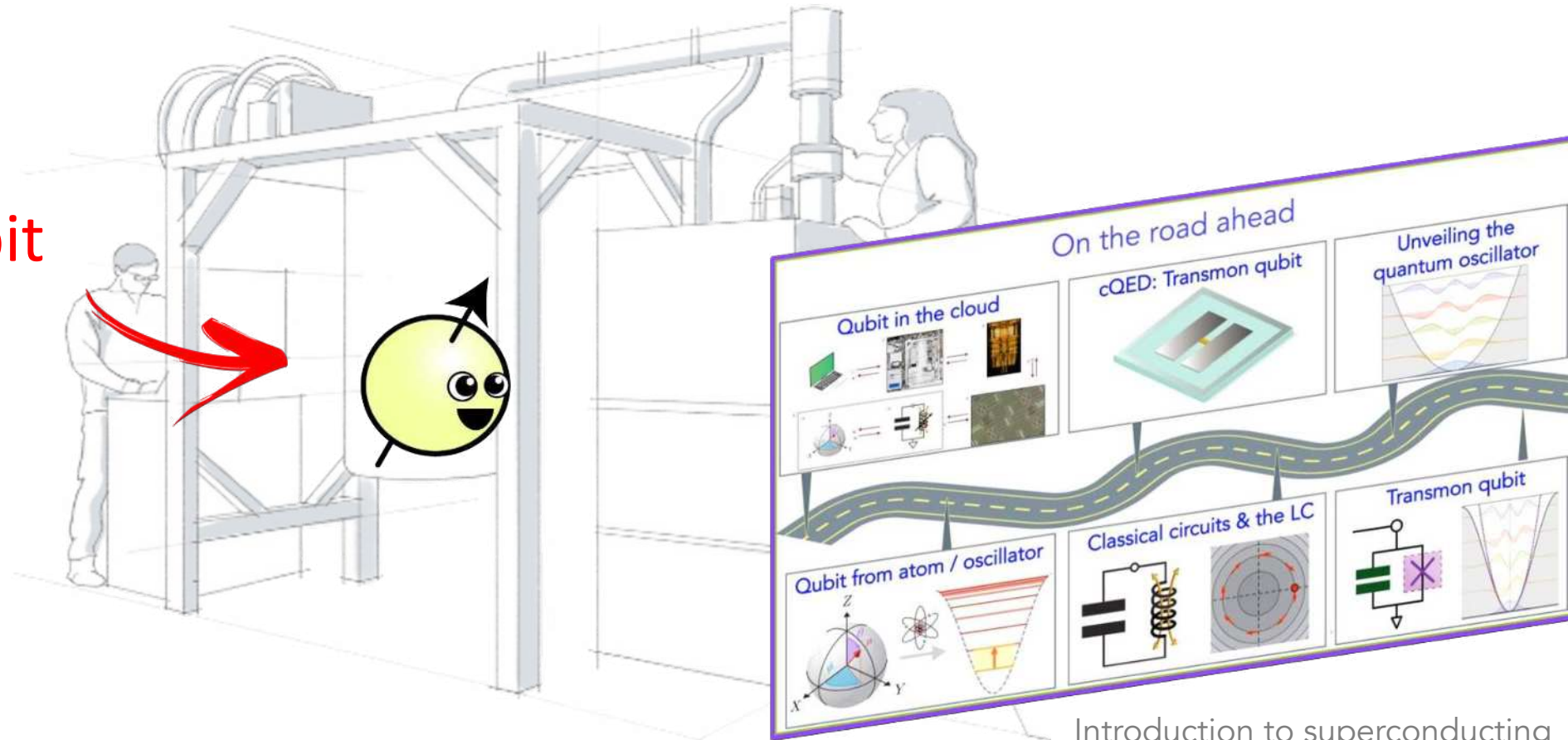
Biggest challenge

Noise
(Errors)



Hello World with a real experiment!

A qubit

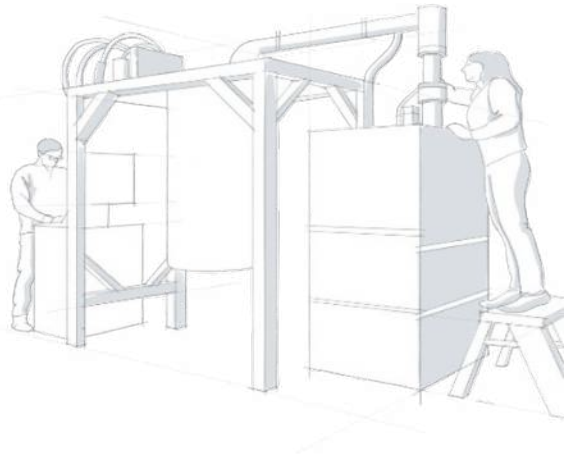


Introduction to superconducting
qubits (cQED)

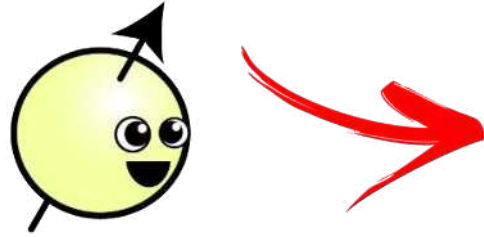
Lecs. 16-21 Minev

QGSS 2020 at qiskit.org/learn

Hello World! building blocks

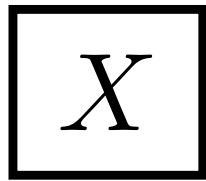


A qubit

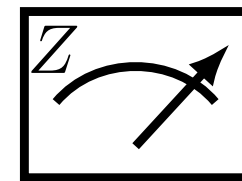
 $|1\rangle$ $|0\rangle$

Computational
basis states

Operations: qubit gate



Measurements: qubit observable



refresher:

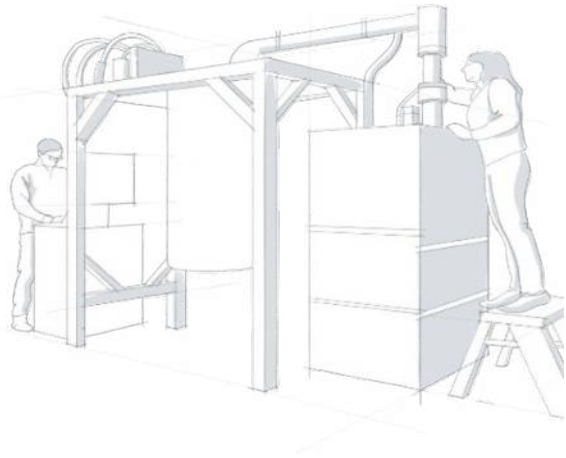
$$X |0\rangle = |1\rangle$$

$$X |1\rangle = |0\rangle$$

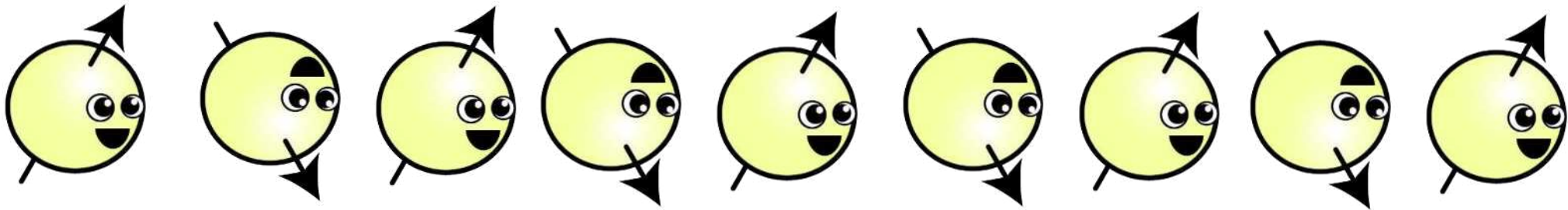
$$Z |0\rangle = +1 |0\rangle$$

$$Z |1\rangle = -1 |1\rangle$$

Hello World! Even-odd algo: qubit flipper



Task: Classify or report if a classical positive integer d is even or odd.



flip spin d times, measure polarization

refresher:

$$X |0\rangle = |1\rangle$$

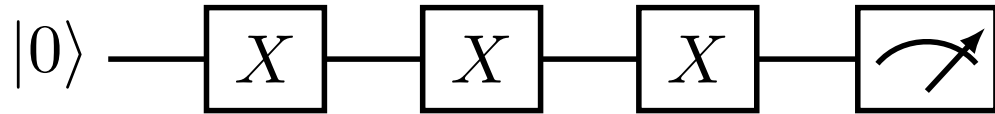
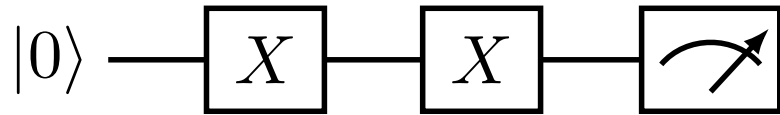
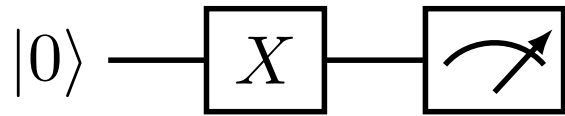
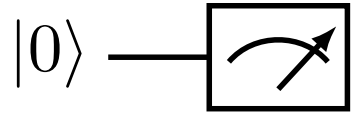
$$X |1\rangle = |0\rangle$$

$$Z |0\rangle = +1 |0\rangle$$

$$Z |1\rangle = -1 |1\rangle$$

Hello World! qubit flipper quantum circuits

depth



⋮

refresher:

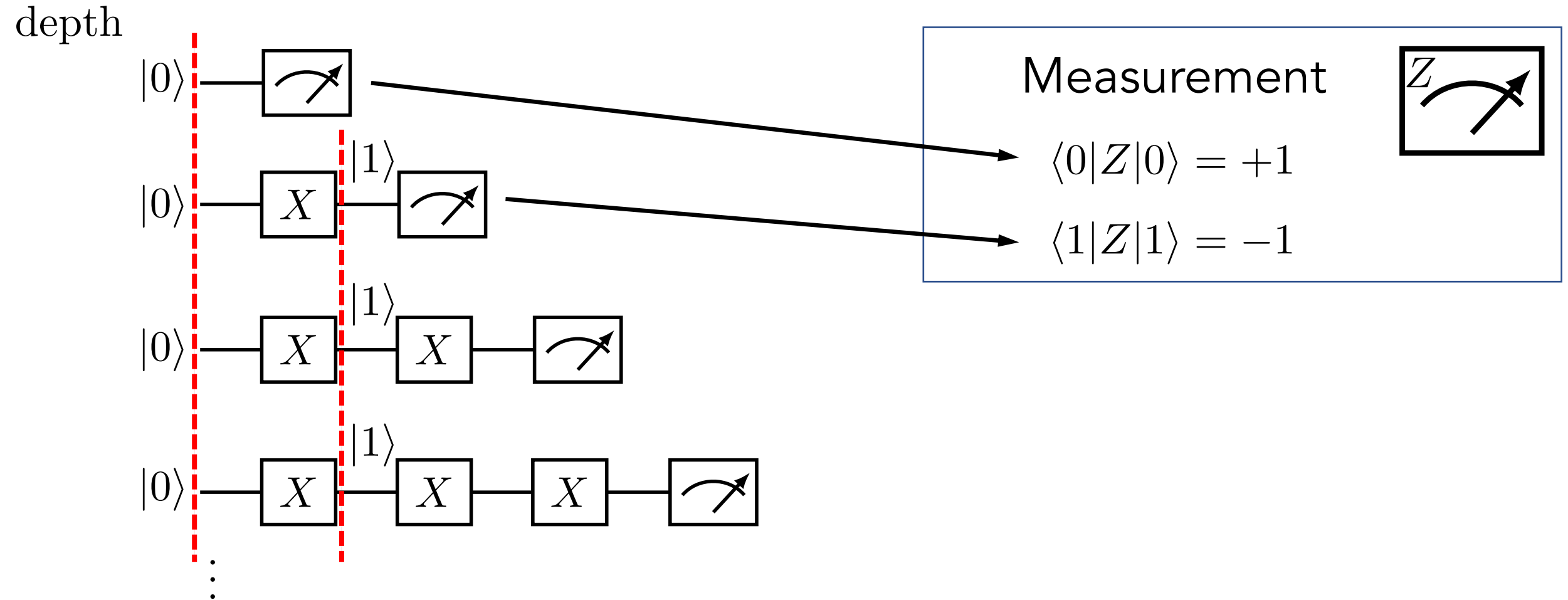
$$X |0\rangle = |1\rangle$$

$$X |1\rangle = |0\rangle$$

$$Z |0\rangle = +1 |0\rangle$$

$$Z |1\rangle = -1 |1\rangle$$

Hello World! “debugger” step through



refresher:

$$X |0\rangle = |1\rangle$$

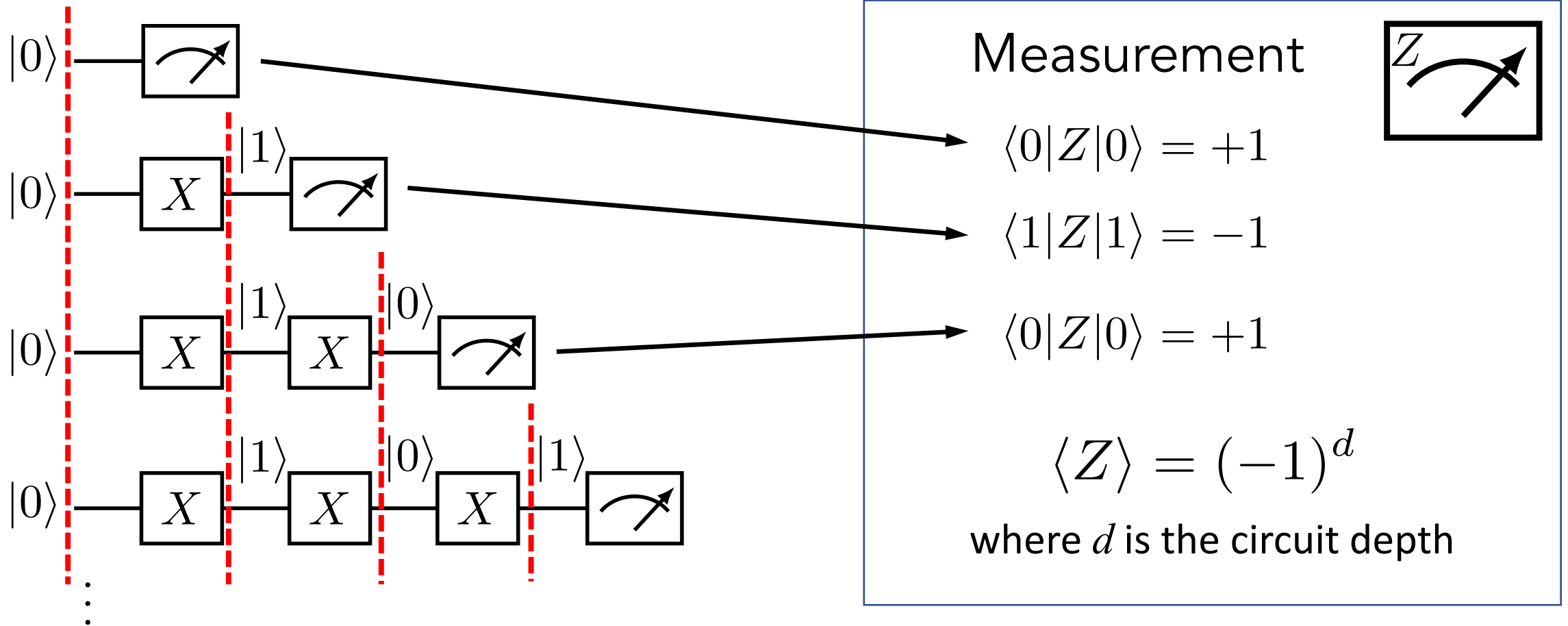
$$X |1\rangle = |0\rangle$$

$$Z |0\rangle = +1 |0\rangle$$

$$Z |1\rangle = -1 |1\rangle$$

Hello World! “debugger” step through

depth



refresher:

$$X |0\rangle = |1\rangle$$

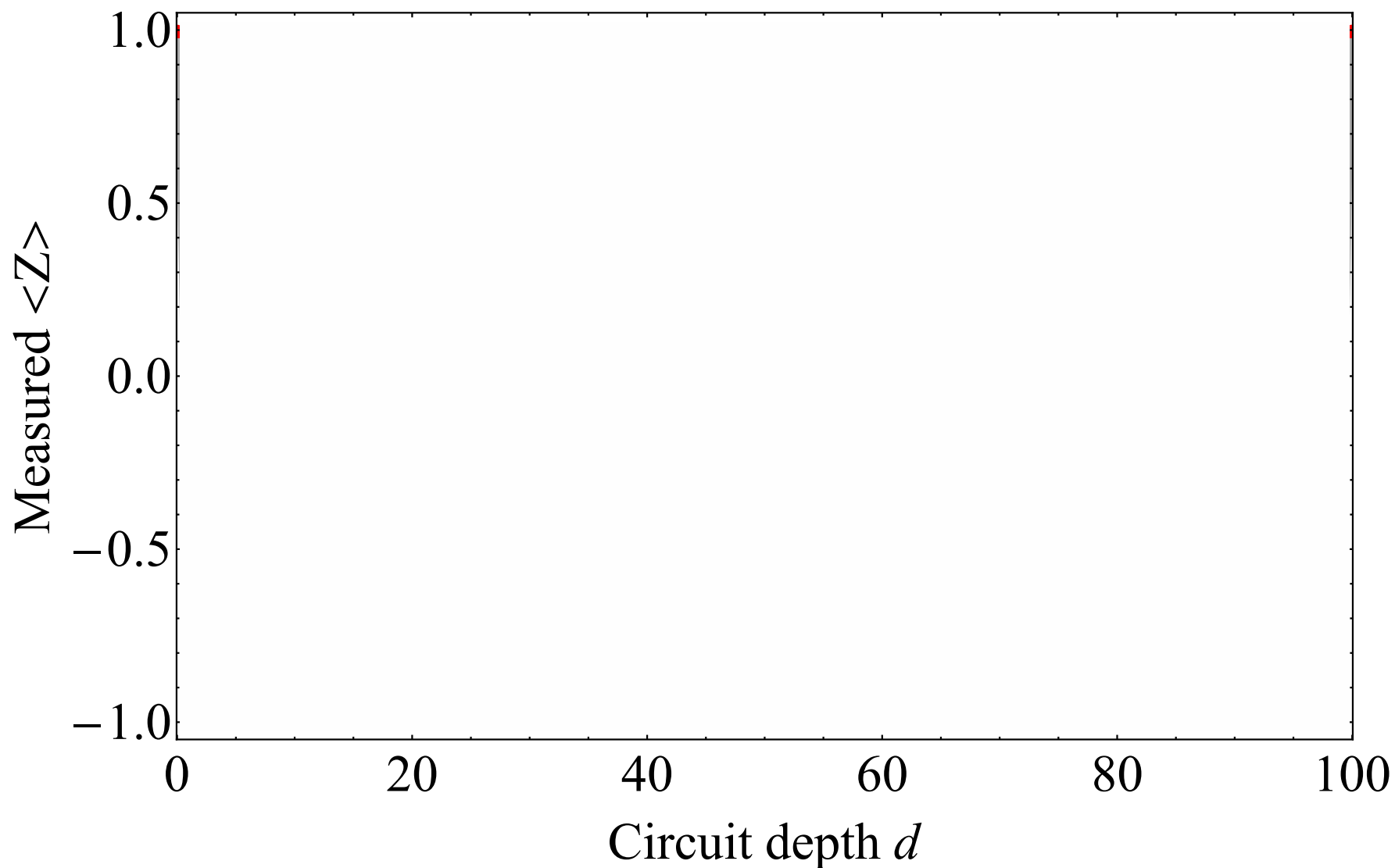
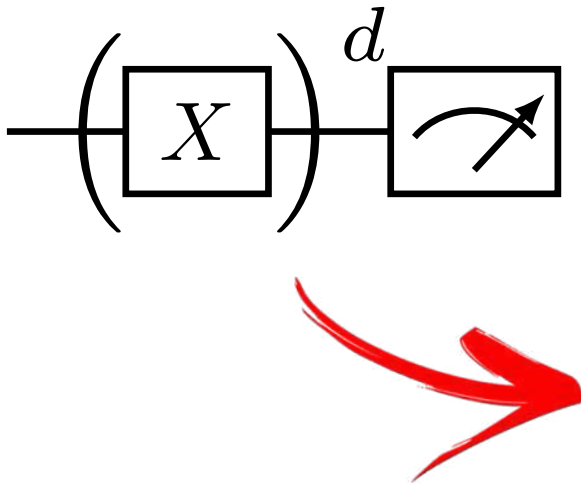
$$X |1\rangle = |0\rangle$$

$$Z |0\rangle = +1 |0\rangle$$

$$Z |1\rangle = -1 |1\rangle$$

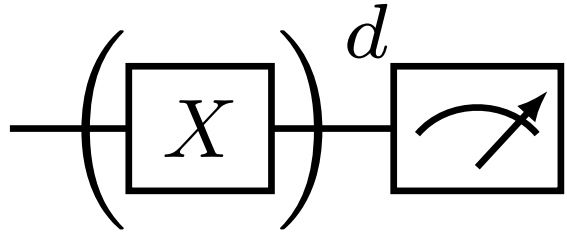
Hello World! Ideal expectation results

$$\langle Z \rangle = (-1)^d$$

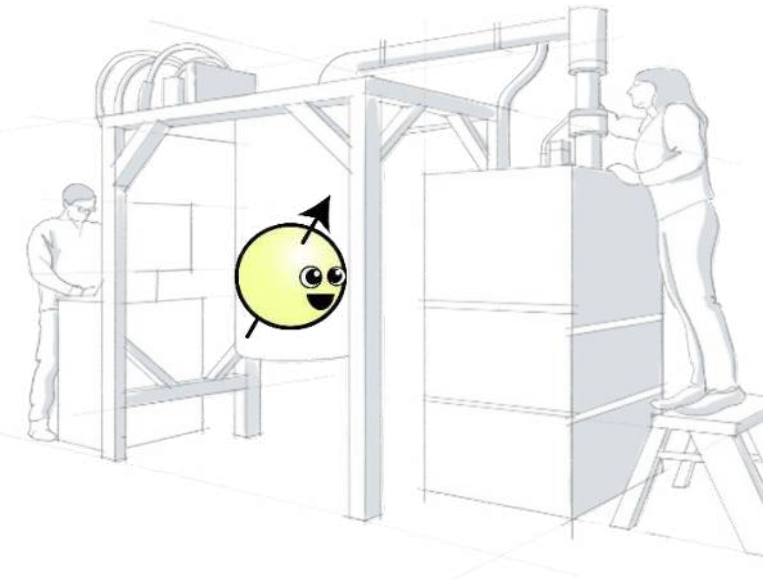


Hello World! Ideal expectation results

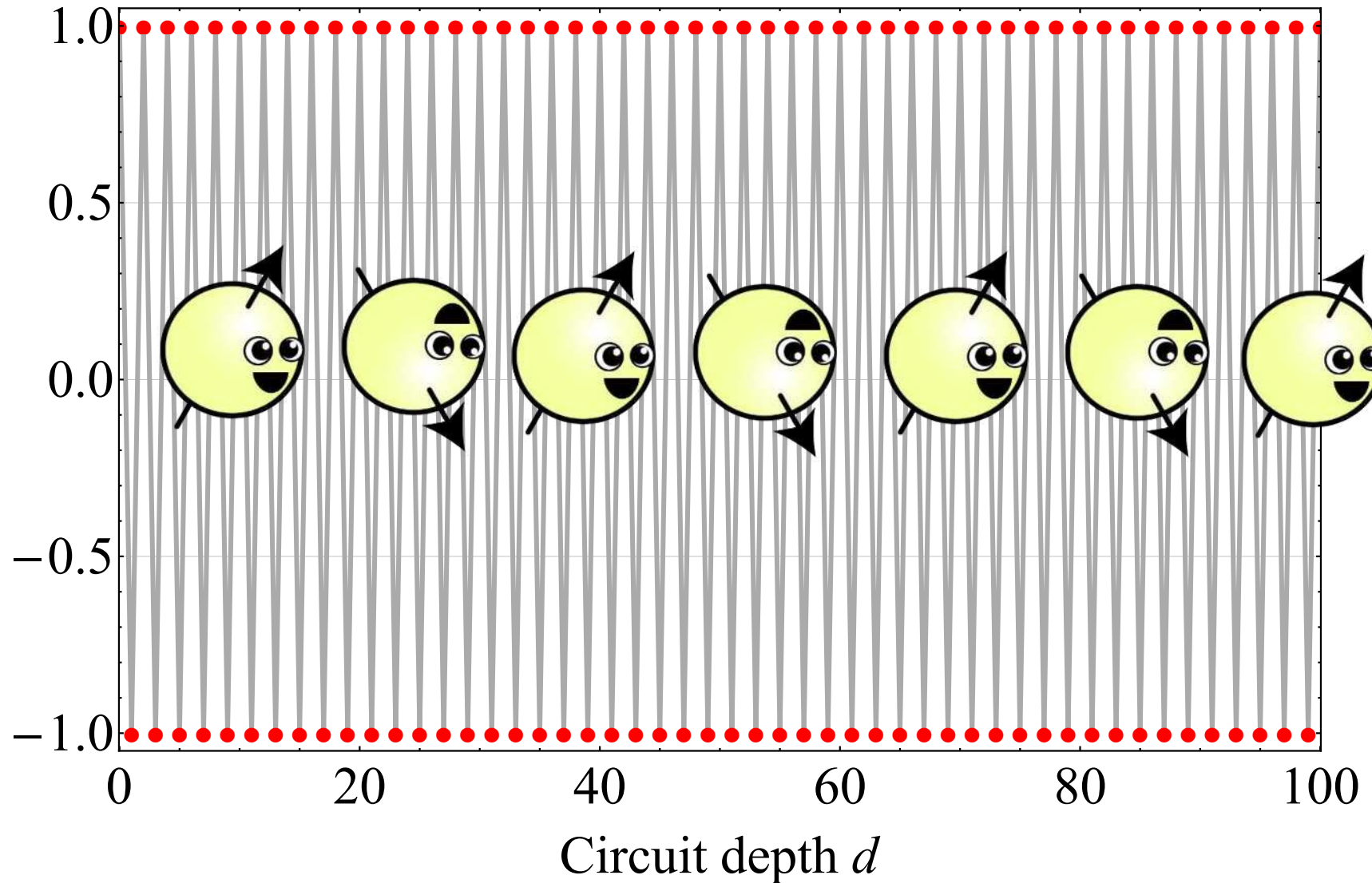
$$\langle Z \rangle = (-1)^d$$



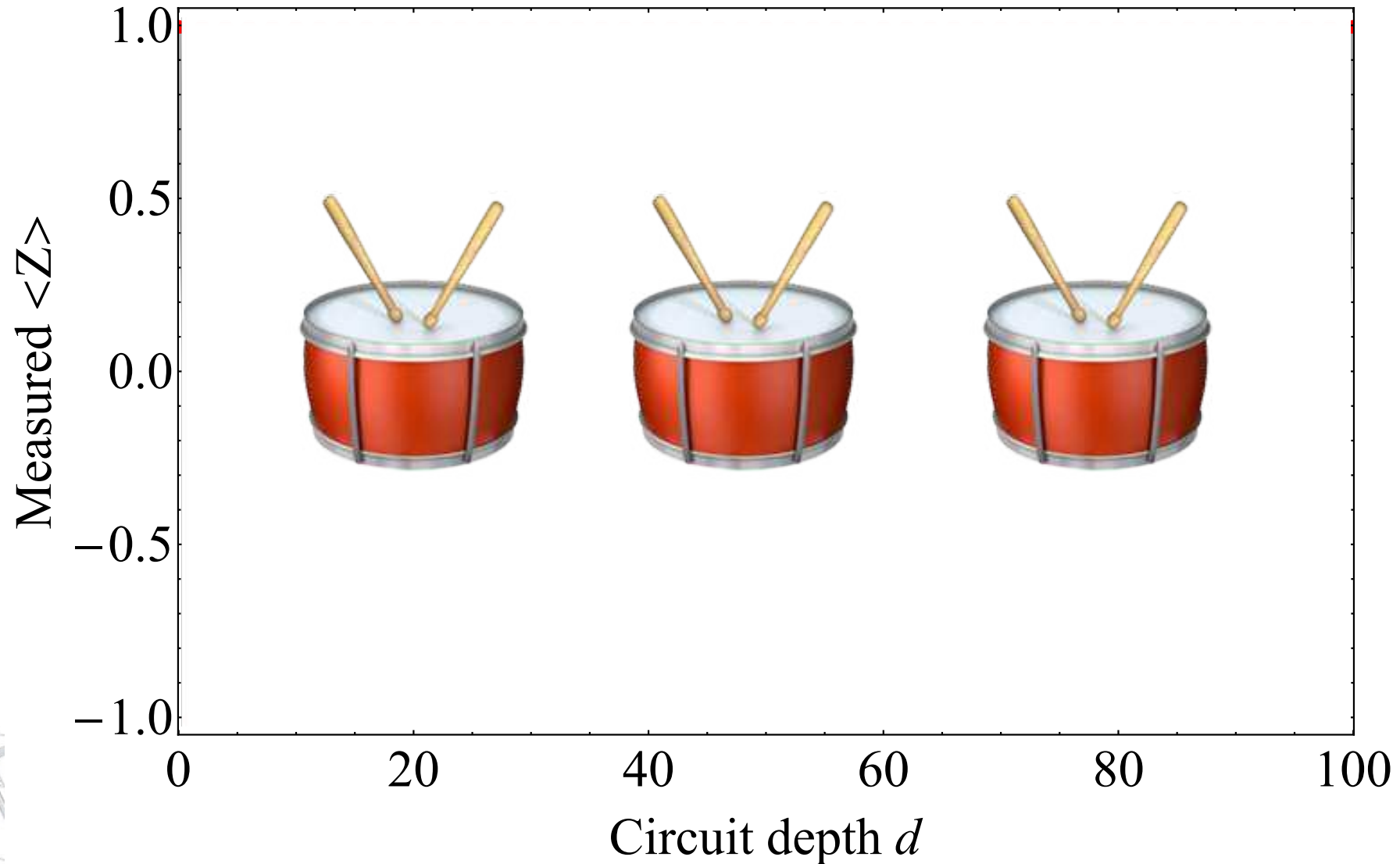
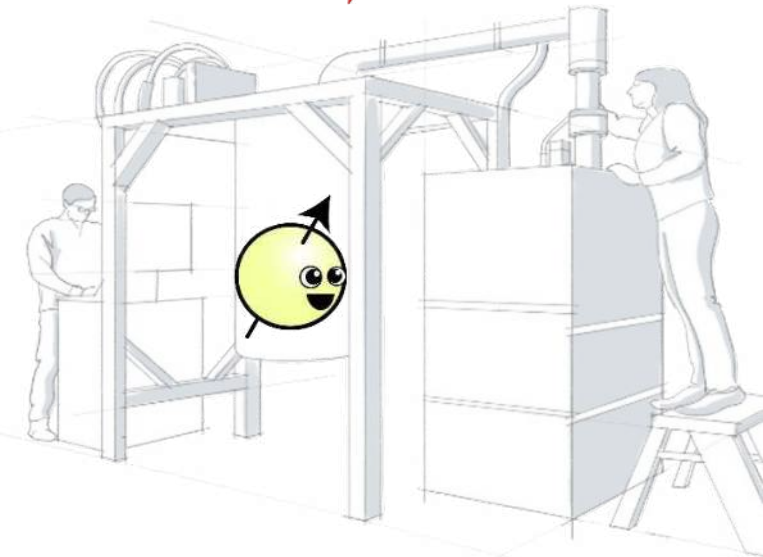
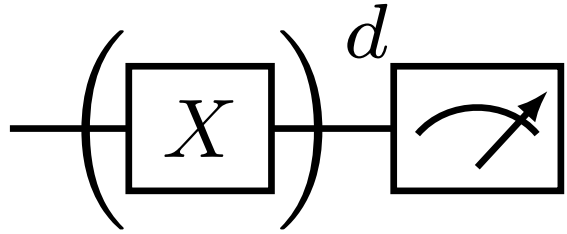
Let's run on a real device!



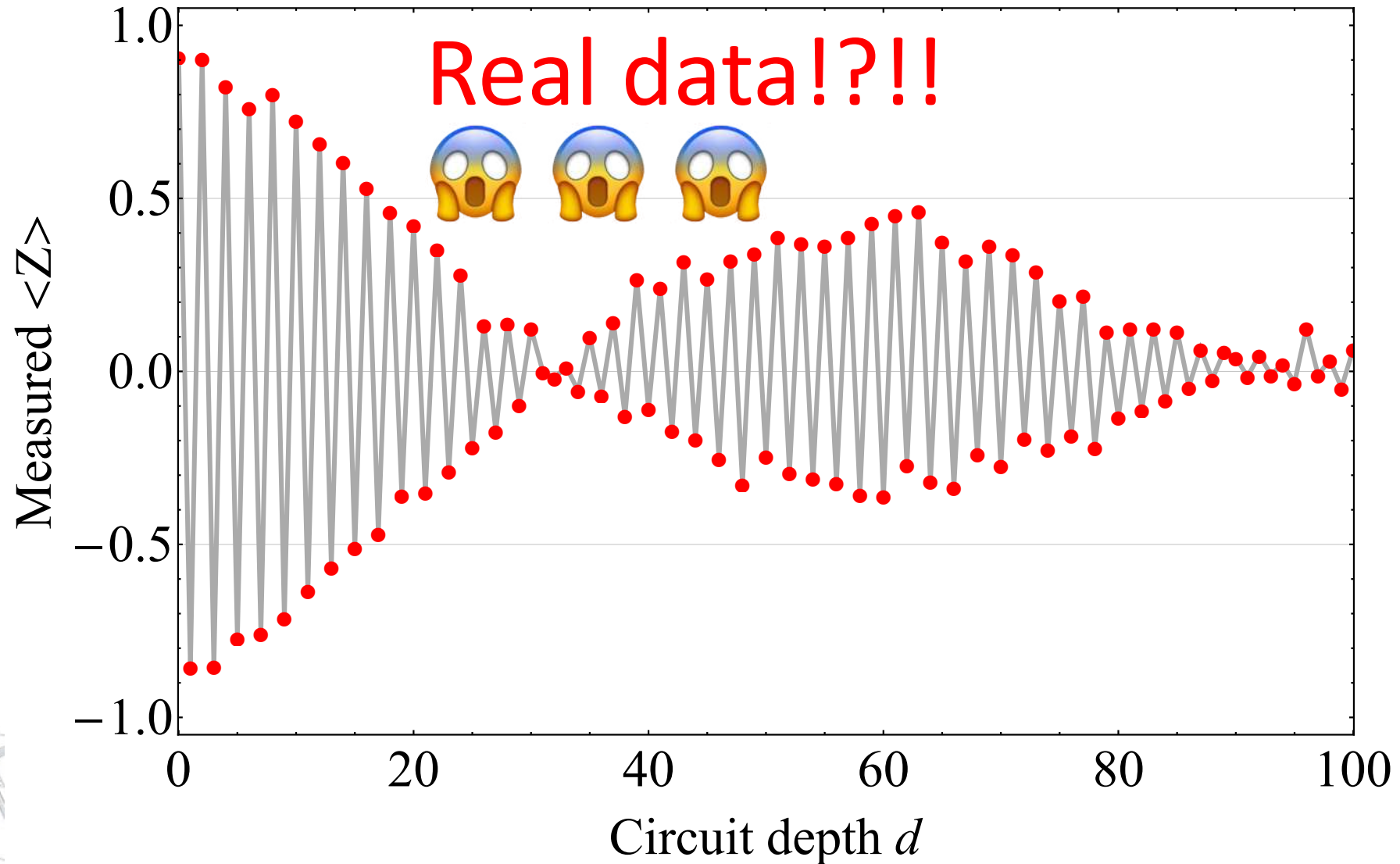
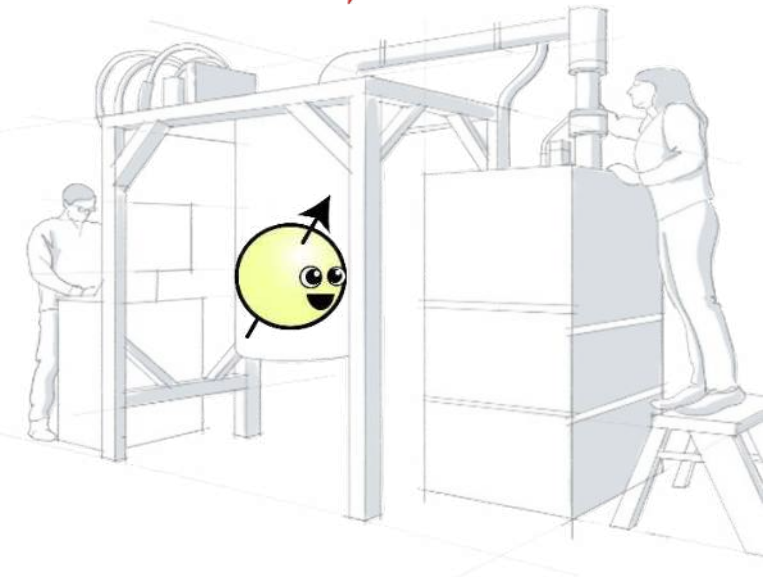
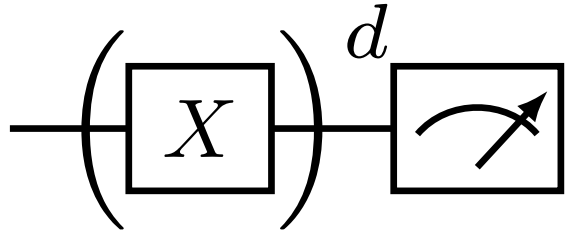
Measured $\langle Z \rangle$



Hello World! Running



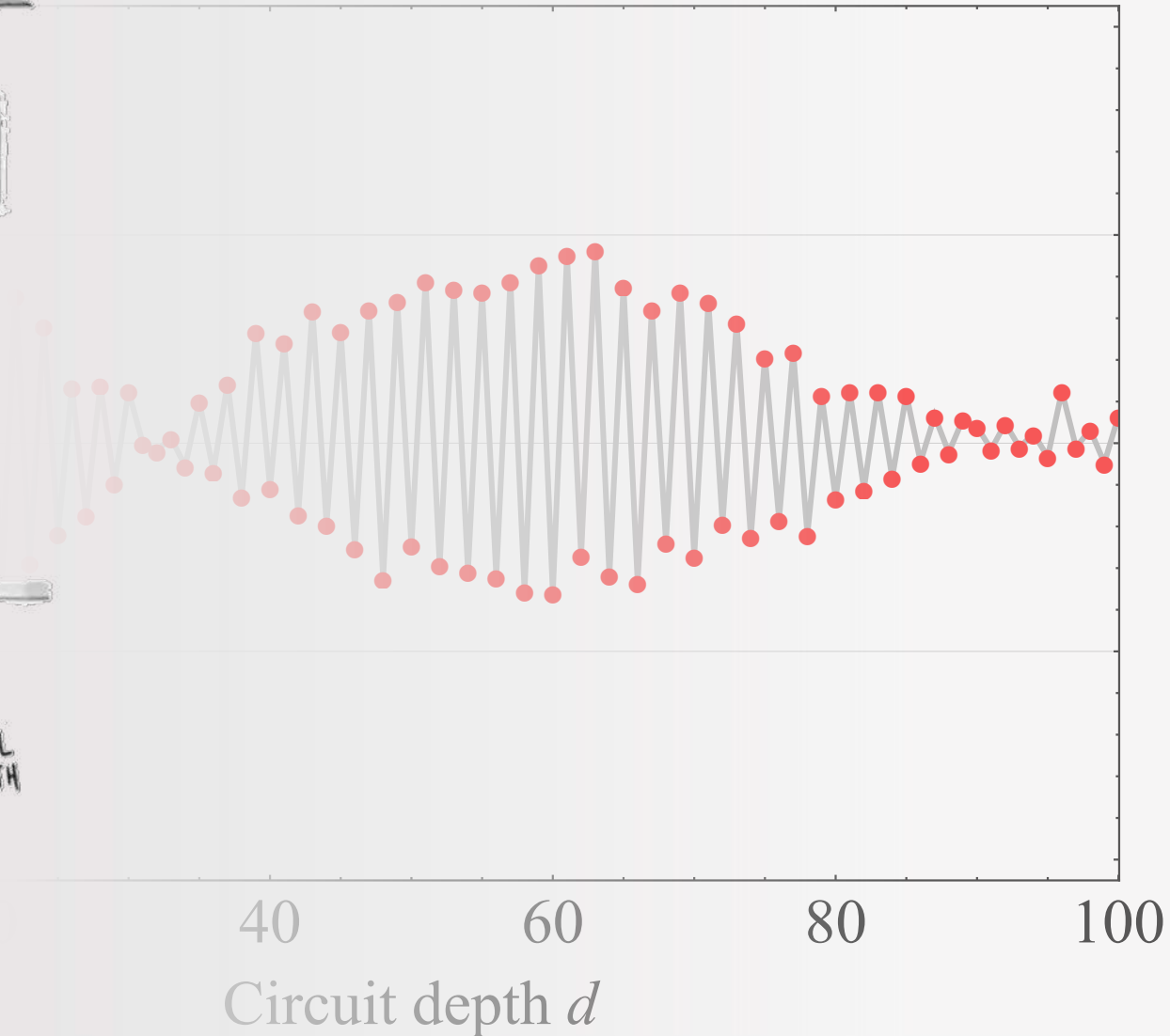
Hello World! Real expectation results

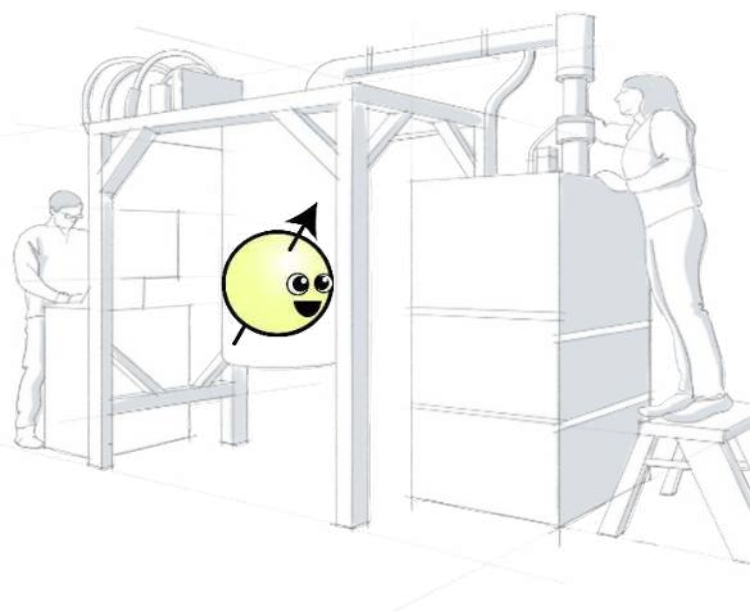


Real & noisy quantum processors: Why study noise?



“Well, your quantum computer is broken in every way possible simultaneously.”

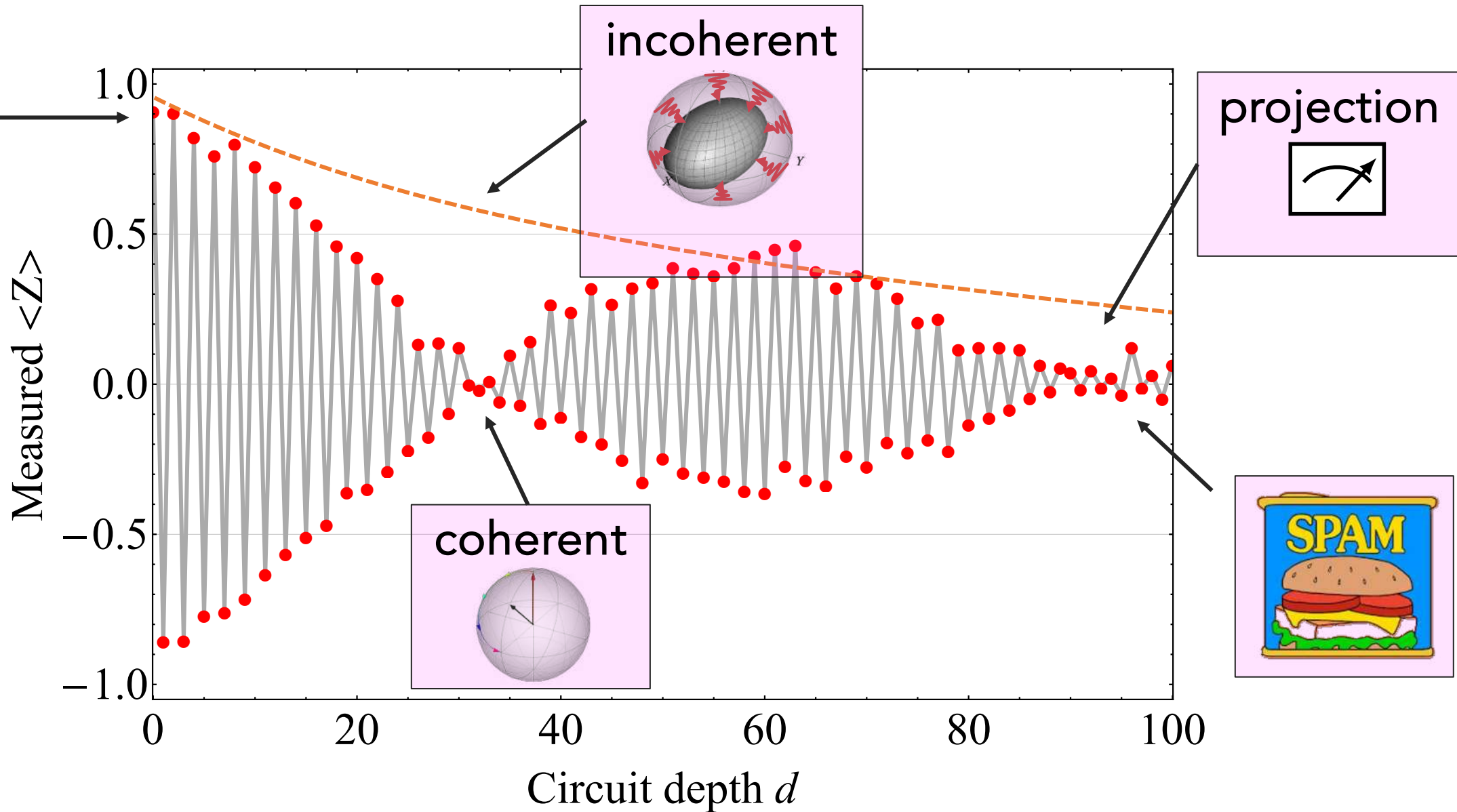




"Quantum phenomena
do *not* occur in a Hilbert space,
they occur in a laboratory."

Asher Peres

Elements of 🤯 noise



How to deal with errors due to noise?

Monitor
Error occurs
Error detect



Quantum error correction

Shor, PRA (1995), ...

Monitor
Error anticipated
Tell signal detected



Catch and reverse

Minev, Nature (2019), ...

No monitor
Error occurs
Error undetected

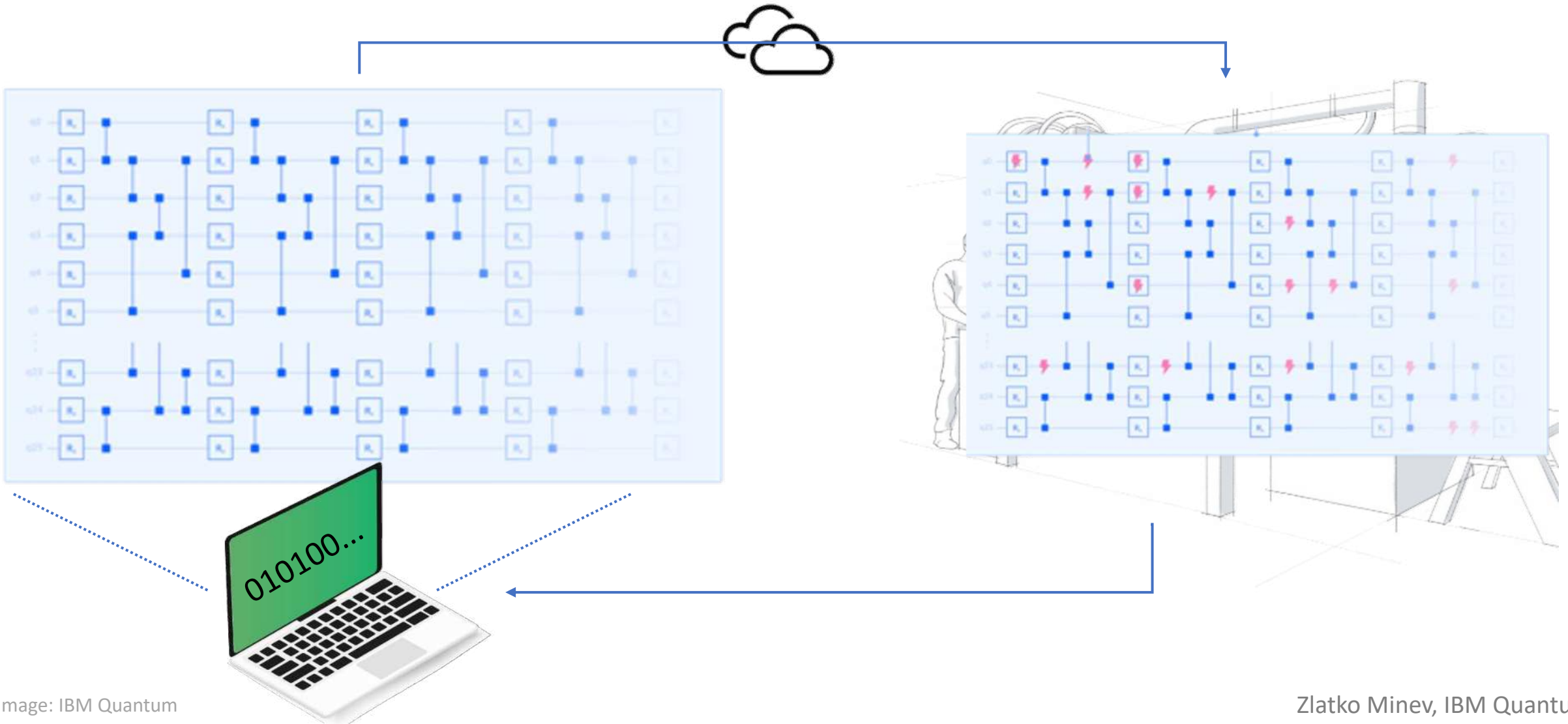


Error mitigation

... subject of today

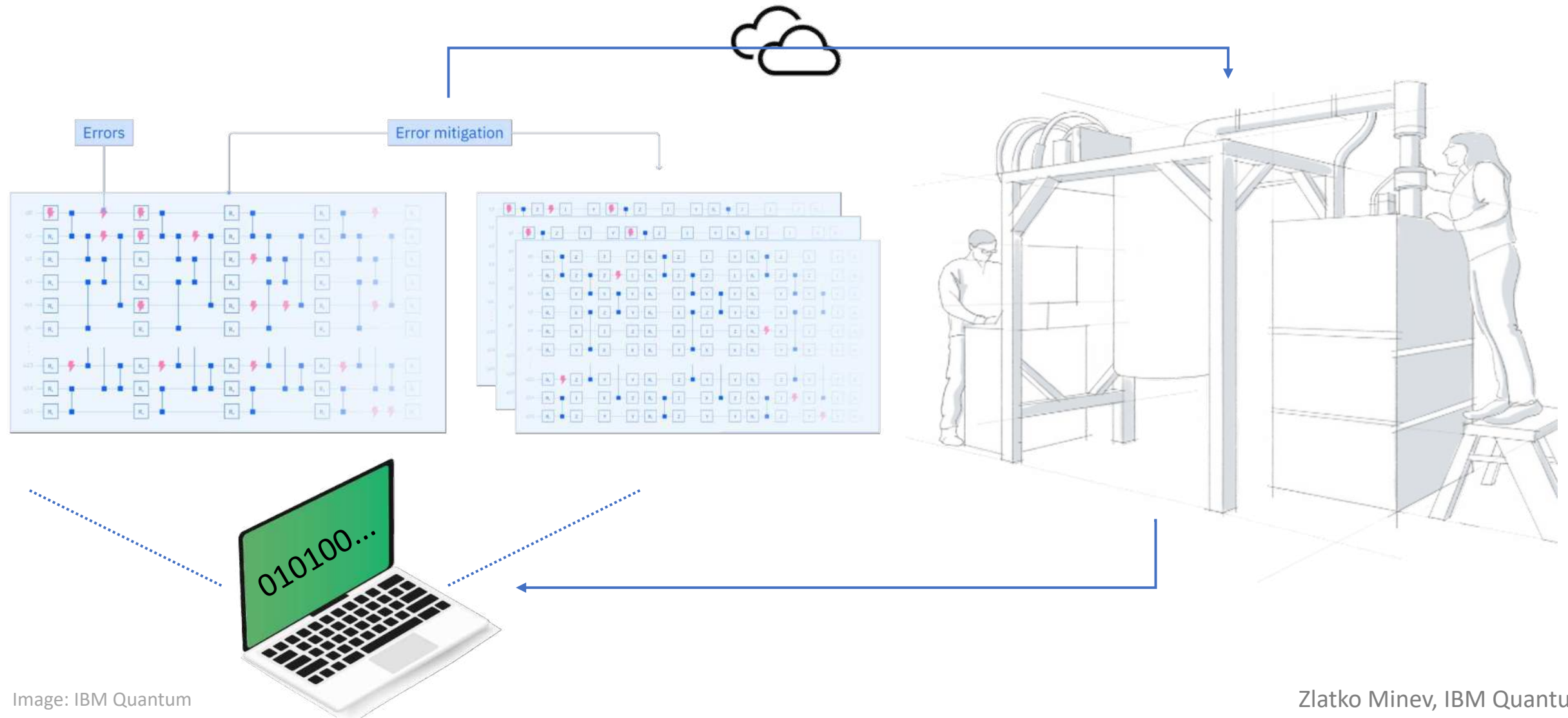
Quantum simulation on a noisy quantum computer

Execute on a real quantum computer device and obtain results as classical data

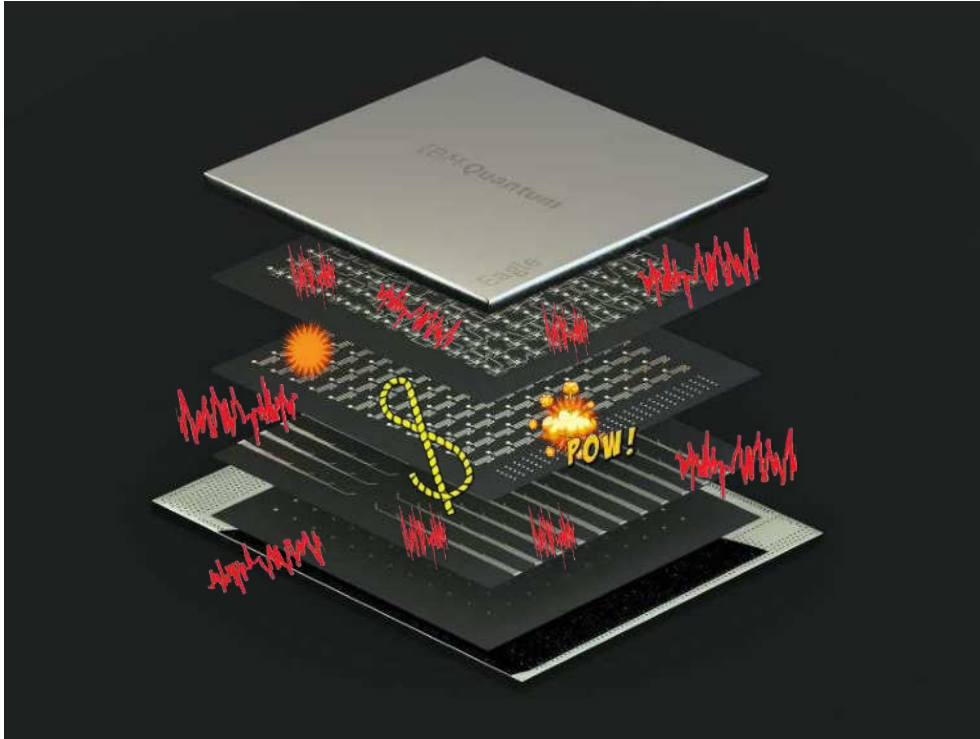


Quantum error mitigation overview

Execute on a real quantum computer device and obtain results as classical data



Error mitigation and error correction



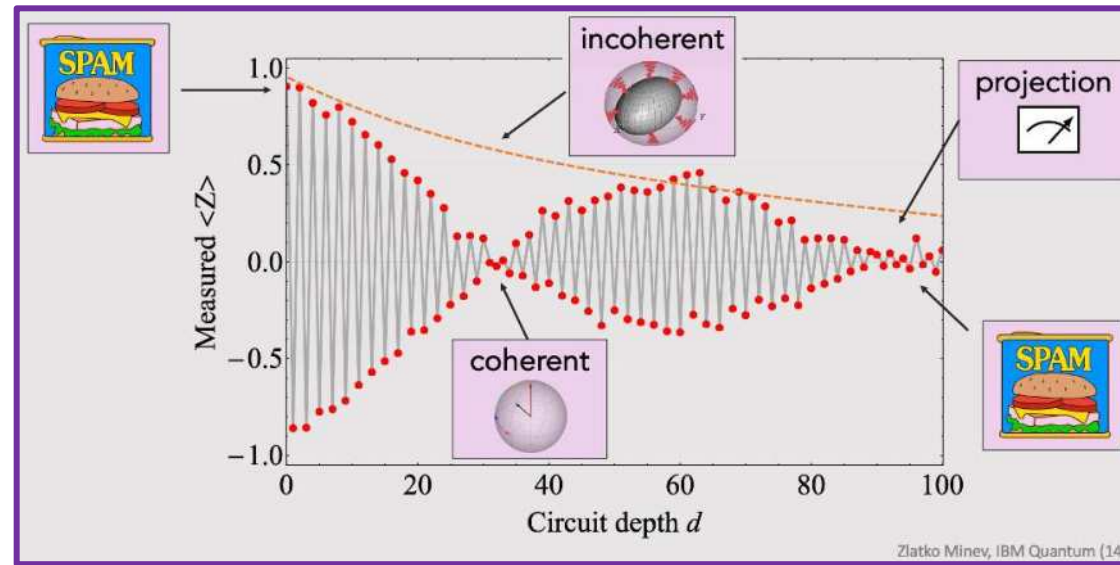
Error mitigation: working with what you have

- **benefit** suppress errors on classical results (expectation values)
- **q-cost** no extra qubits or hardware resources needed
- **c-cost** trades classical resources (post-processing) for lower error
- **limitation** bad asymptotic scaling: high number of samples & circuits

Error correction: protecting quantum information

- **benefit** suppress & correct errors to arbitrarily small level
- **q-cost** very large qubit and hardware overhead
- **c-cost** decoding and encoding can be classically costly
- **challenge** requires fault-tolerant operations and readout

Error mitigation landscape



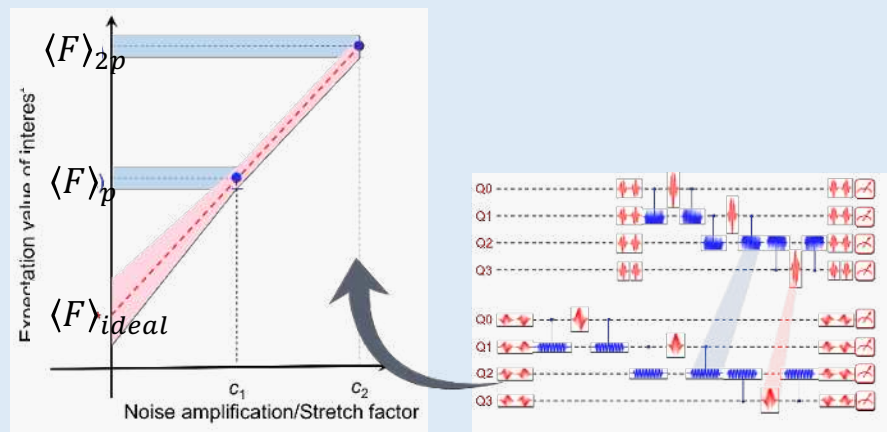
more
speed

more information,
accuracy



Error mitigation landscape

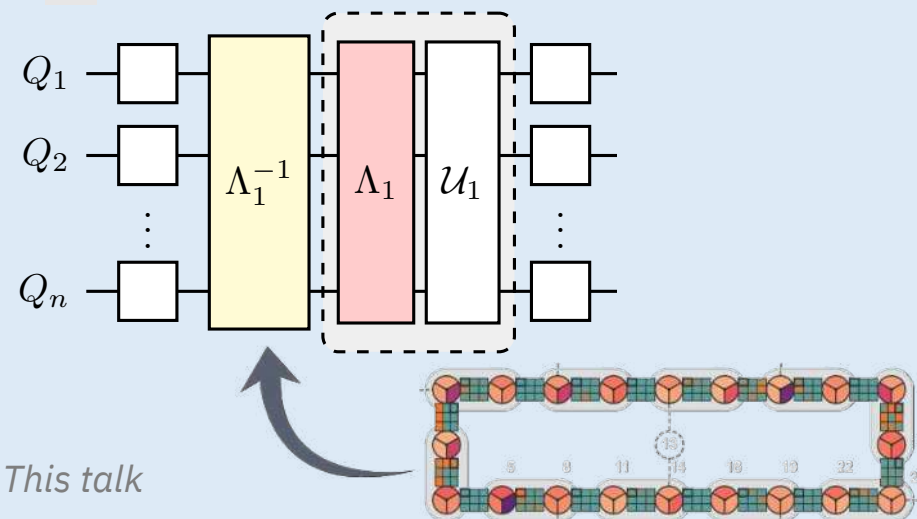
Zero-noise extrapolation (ZNE)



Nature 567, 491 (2019)

35

Probabilistic error cancellation (PEC)



more
speed



more information,
accuracy

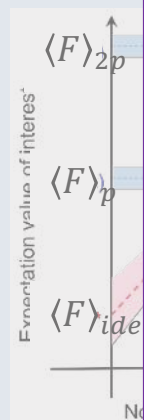


Zlatko Minev, IBM Quantum (35)

Error mitigation landscape

Zero-noise extrapolation (ZNE)

Probabilistic error cancelation (PEC)



 **Qiskit** **IBM Qiskit**

OverviewLearnCommunity

English

Search Qiskit Runtime IBM

Get started

Overview

Getting Started

backend.run vs. Qiskit Runtime

Introduction to primitives

Tutorials

Get started with Estimator

Get started with error suppression and error mitigation

VQE with Estimator

CHSH with Estimator

Get started with Sampler

Qiskit Runtime IBM Client documentation > Error suppression and error mitigation with Qiskit Runtime

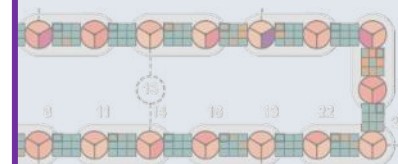
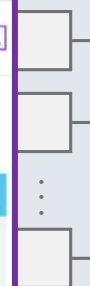
NOTE

This page was generated from [docs/tutorials/Error-Suppression-and-Error-Mitigation.ipynb](#).

Error suppression and error mitigation with Qiskit Runtime

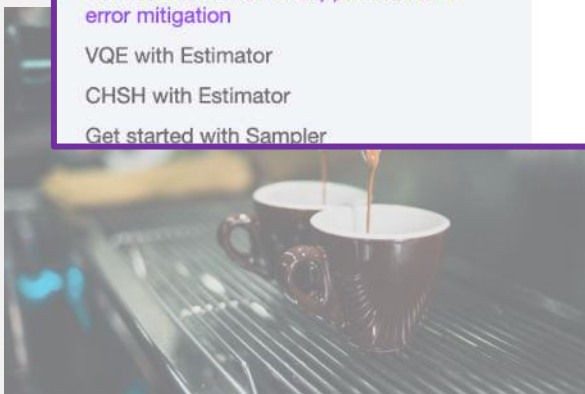
```
[1]: import datetime
import numpy as np
import matplotlib as mpl
import matplotlib.pyplot as plt
plt.rcParams.update({"text.usetex": True})
plt.rcParams["figure.figsize"] = (6,4)
mpl.rcParams["figure.dpi"] = 200

from qiskit_ibm_runtime import Estimator, Session, QiskitRuntimeService,
Options
from qiskit.quantum_info import SparsePauliOp
from qiskit import QuantumCircuit
```



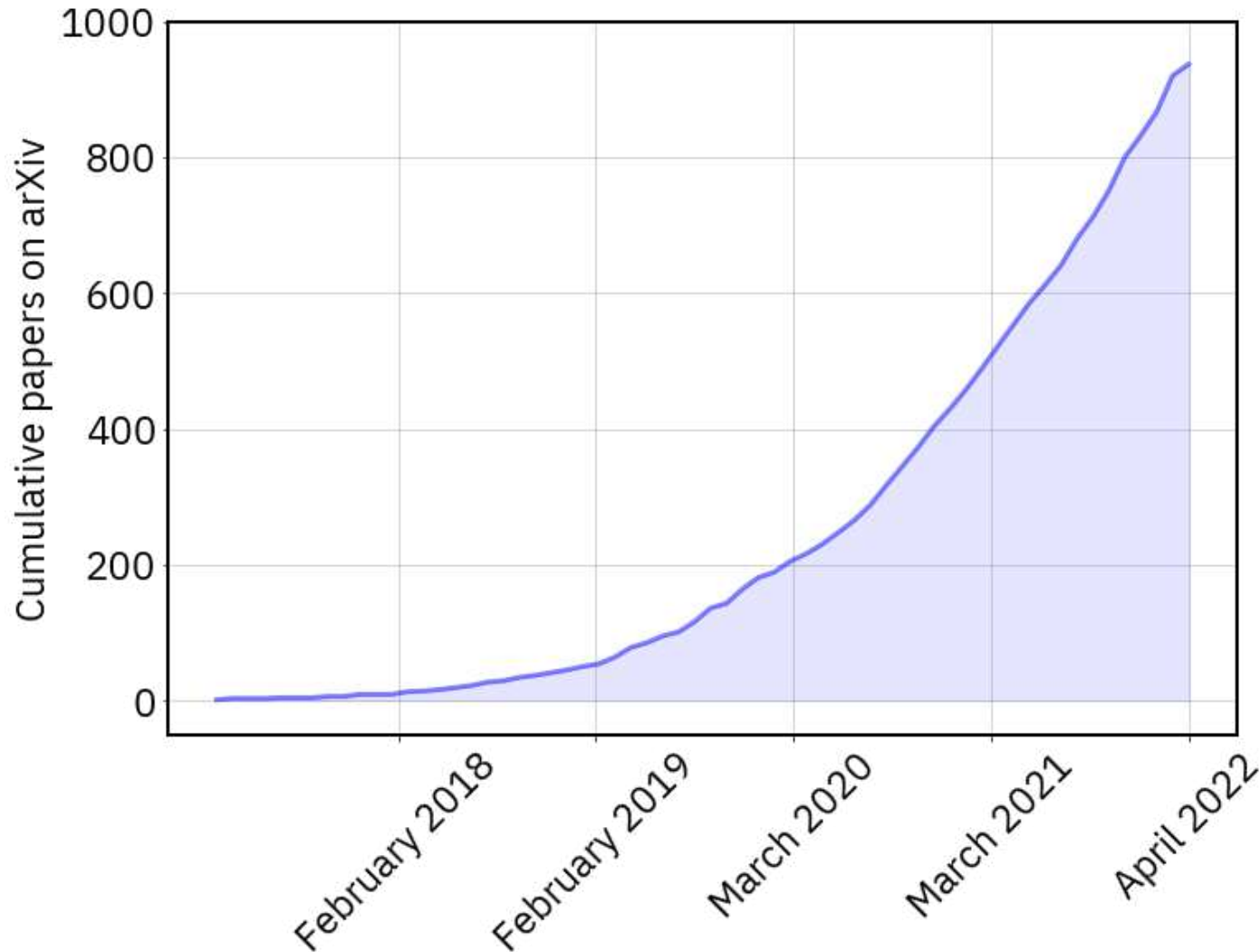
more
speed

more information,
accuracy



Adoption of error mitigation

Papers involving error mitigation over time



Examples

ARTICLE
<https://doi.org/10.1038/s41467-020-14376-x> OPEN
Error-mitigated quantum gates exceeding physical fidelities in a trapped-ion system
Shuaining Zhang¹, Yao Lu¹, Kuan Zhang^{1,2}, Wentao Chen¹, Ying Li^{3*}, Jing-Ning Zhang^{1,4*} & Kihwan Kim^{1*}

Matrix product channel: Variation to mitigate noise and reduce errors
Sergey Filippov,^{*} Boris Sokolov, Ma Borrelli, Daniel Cavalcanti, Sabrina Algorithmiq Ltd, Kanavakat

Article | Published: 08 May 2023
Probabilistic error cancellation with sparse Pauli-Lindblad models on noisy quantum processors
Ewout van den Berg, Zlatko K. Minev, Abhinav Kandala & Kristan Temme
Nature Physics (2023) | [Cite this article](#)

Quantum Error Mitigation
Zhenyu Cai,^{1,2,*} Ryan Babbush,³ McClean,³ and Thomas E. O'Brien
¹Department of Materials, University
²Quantum Motion, 9 Sterling Way,
³Google Quantum AI, Venice, California
⁴NTT Computer and Data Science
⁵Graduate School of China Academy
(Dated: July 3, 2023)

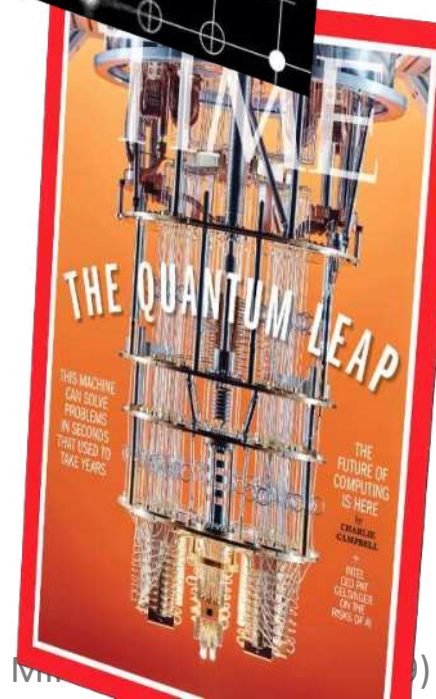
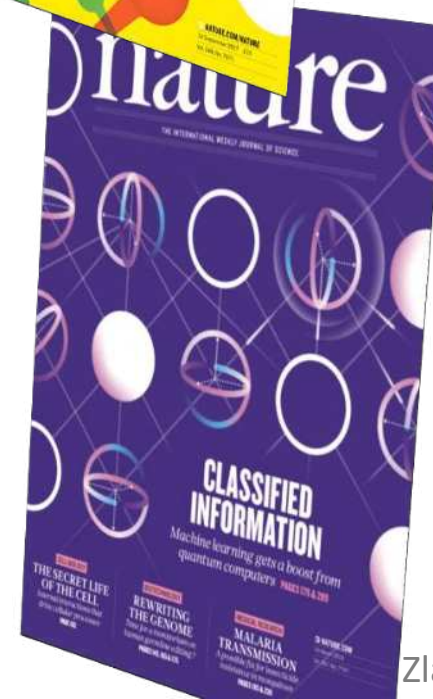
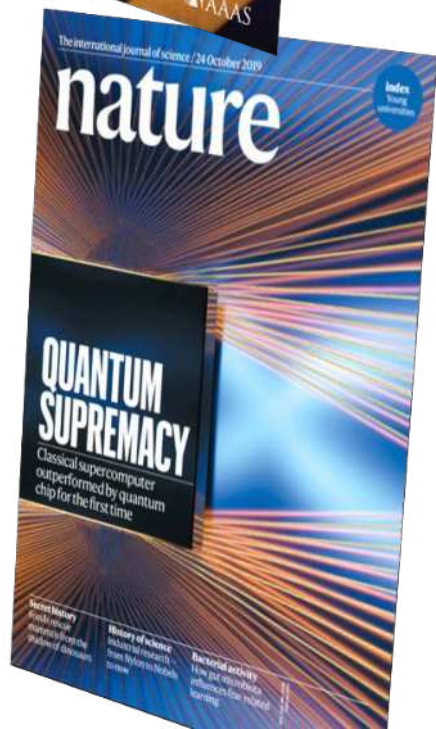
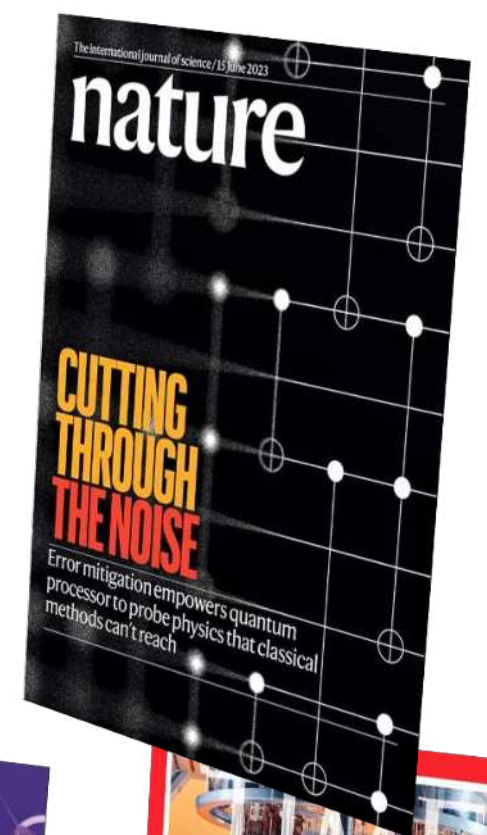
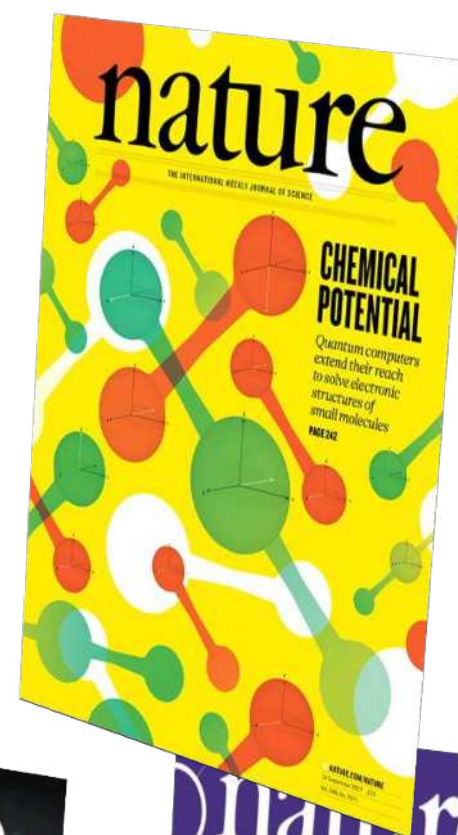
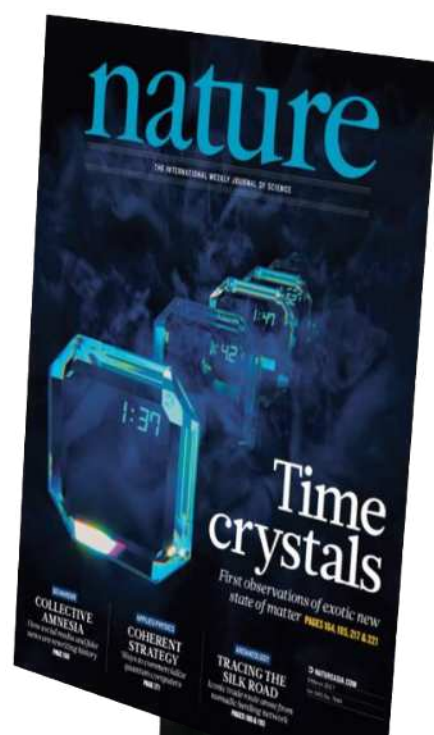
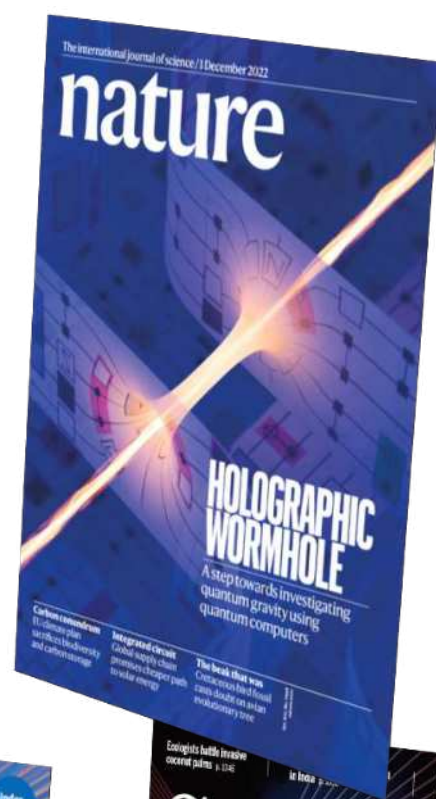
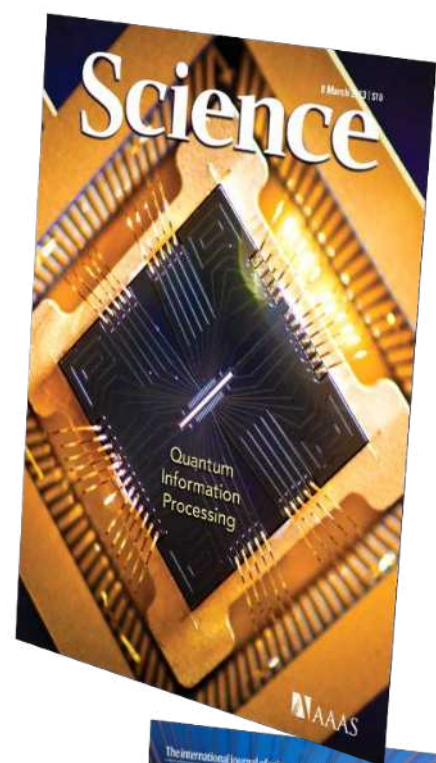
npi | quantum information
ARTICLE OPEN
Fundamental limits of quantum error mitigation
Ryuji Takagi^{1,2}, Suguru Endo^{2,3}, Shintaro Minagawa^{3,4} and Mile Gu^{1,4,5}

PHYSICAL REVIEW LETTERS **127**, 200505 (2021)
Error Mitigation for Universal Gates on Encoded Qubits
Christophe Piveteau
IBM Quantum, IBM Research—Zürich, 8803 Rüschlikon, Switzerland

Single-shot error mitigation
Ewout van den Berg, Sergey B. Ponomarev, Dmitri Maslov, IBM T.J. Watson Research Center, Yorktown Heights, NY 10598, USA
December 2021

Model-free readout-error mitigation for quantum expectation values
Ewout van den Berg, Zlatko K. Minev, and Kristan Temme
Phys. Rev. A **105**, 032620 – Published 30 March 2022

Is science with noisy devices of
broad interest today?



Some of these ideas covered
in other lectures at the
school

Deep dive:

Probabilistic error cancellation (PEC)

To learn and cancel quantum noise



Got Slides?



Ewout van den Berg, Zlatko K. Mineev, Abhinav Kandala, Kristan Temme
Nature Physics (2023)

Cancel quantum noise



High-level message

Learn

accurate, efficient, scalable



Cancel

noise with noise,
practical



Cost

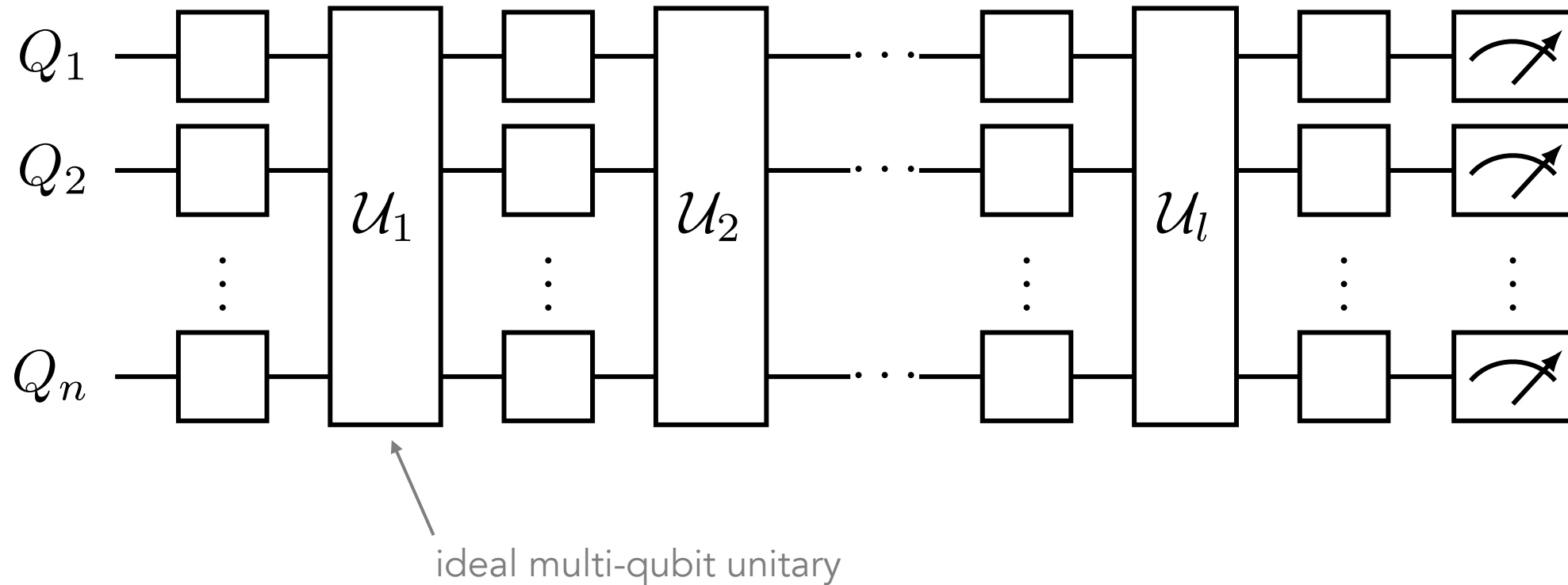
more noise more cost





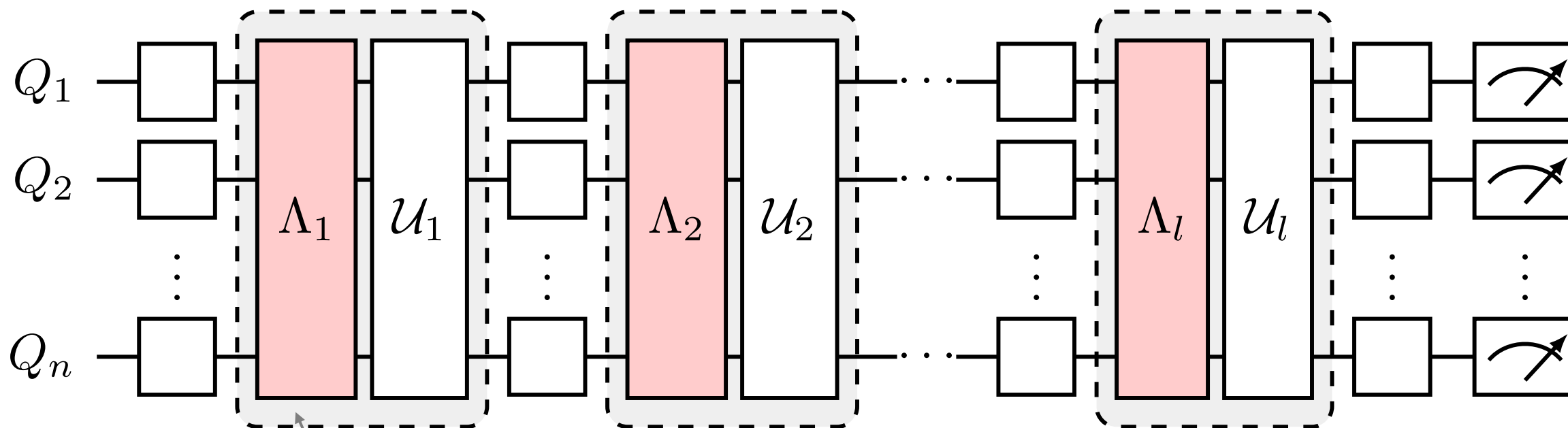
Idea

Ideal (noise-free) quantum circuit



A circuit can be decomposed into a layer construction
Example: Trotterization of Ising model simulation

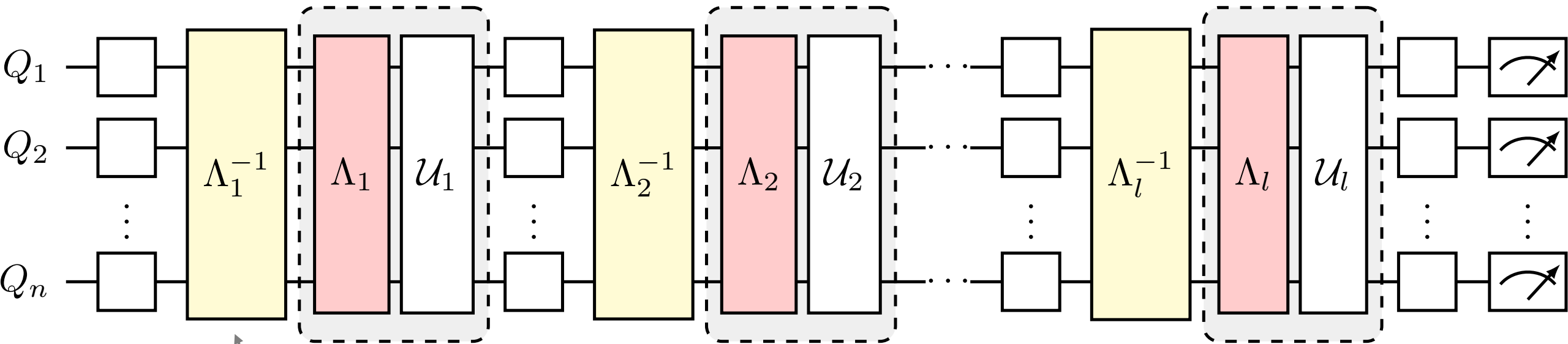
Real (noisy) quantum circuit



multi-qubit noise channel
inseparable from gate

completely positive and trace preserving (CPTP)
representable by a $4^n \times 4^n$ matrix

Why not invert noise?



inverse operation of noise channel

unphysical

would need to know lost information due to noise

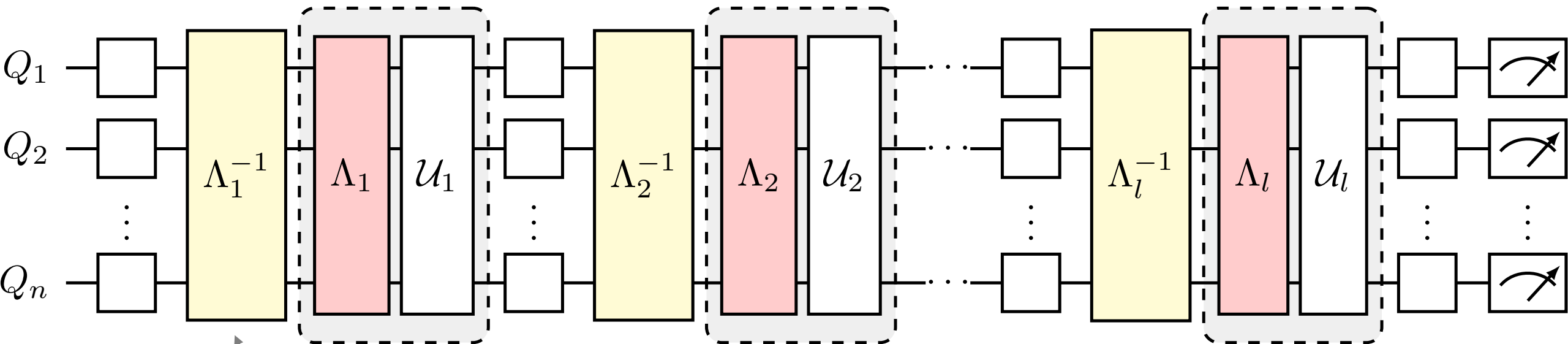
non CPTP map

has negative eigenvalues

...

Not possible?

Probabilistic error cancellation



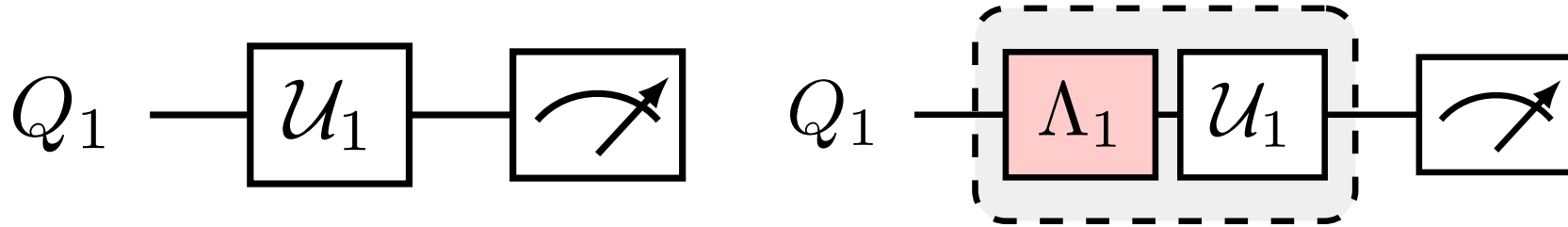
inverse operation of noise channel
implement on average



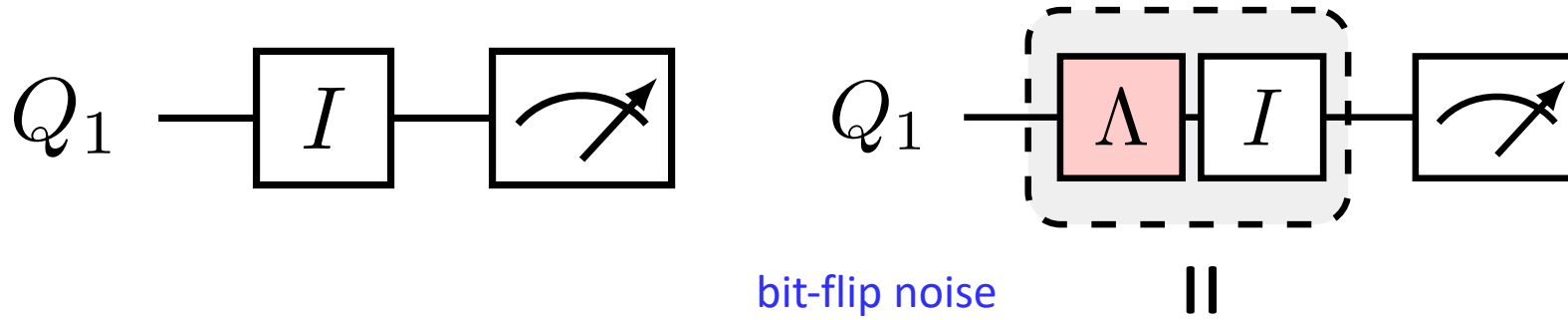
K. Temme, S. Bravyi, and J. M. Gambetta
PRL 119, 180509 (2017)

See also S. Endo, S. Benjamin, and Y. Li
Phys. Rev. X 8, 031027 (2018)

Toy model

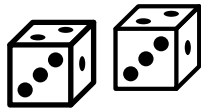


Toy model: noise unraveling into quantum trajectories

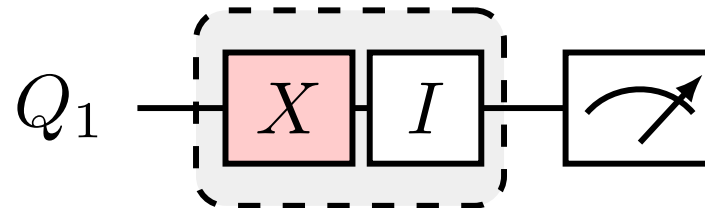
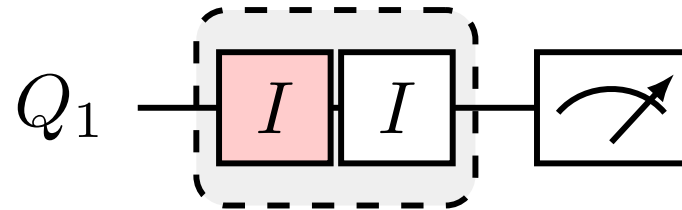


unraveling
(quantum trajectories)

probability $1-p$

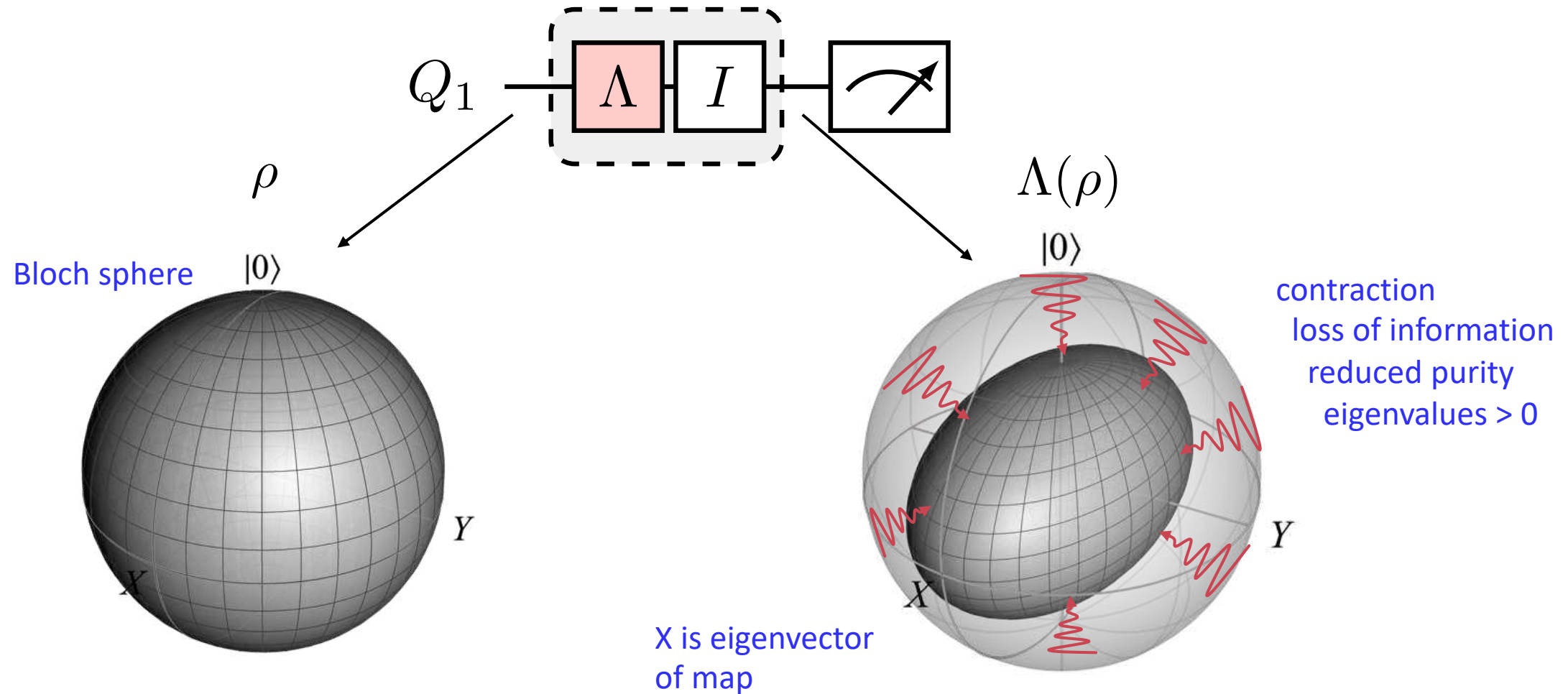


probability p

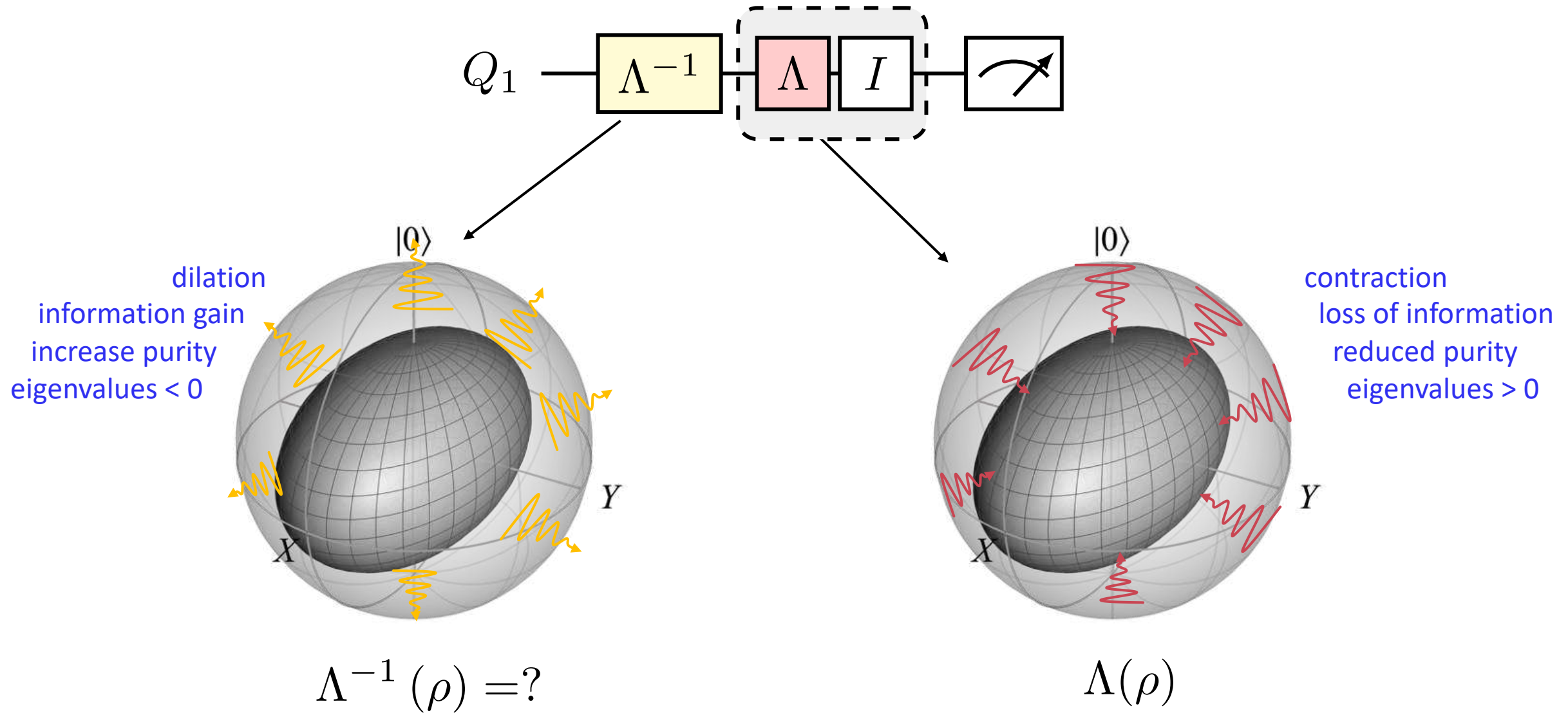


$$\Lambda(\rho) = (1 - p)I\rho I + pX\rho X$$

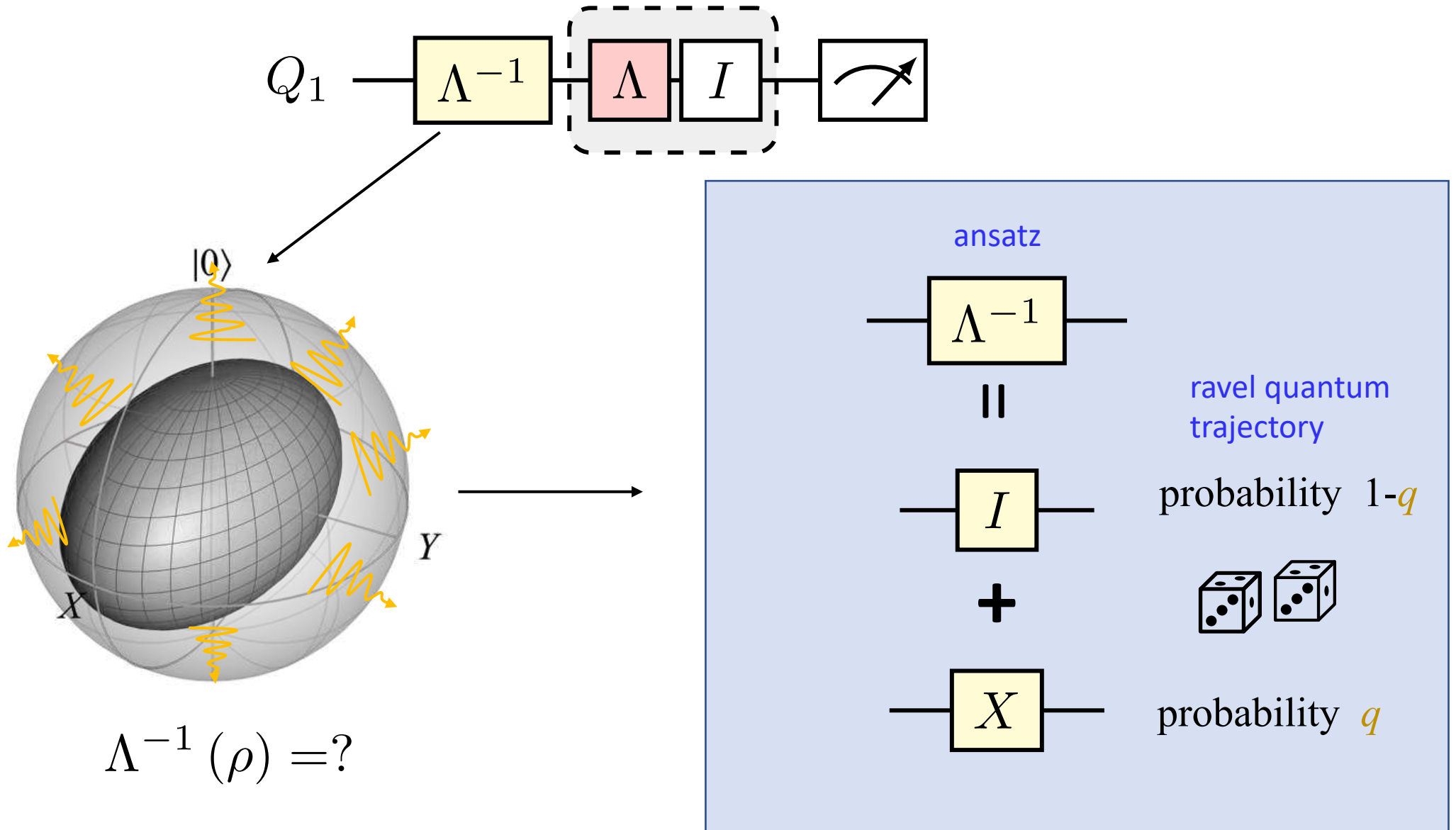
Toy model: noise unraveling into quantum trajectories



Inverse of noise map is not physical

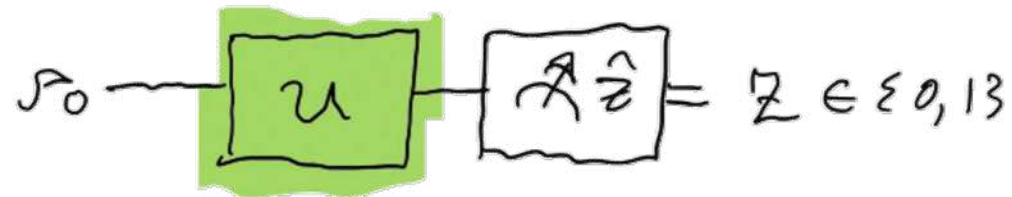


Inverse of noise map is not physical



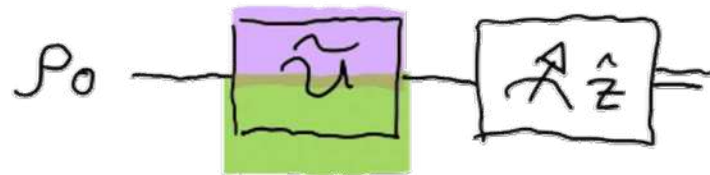
Blackboard derivation

Setup

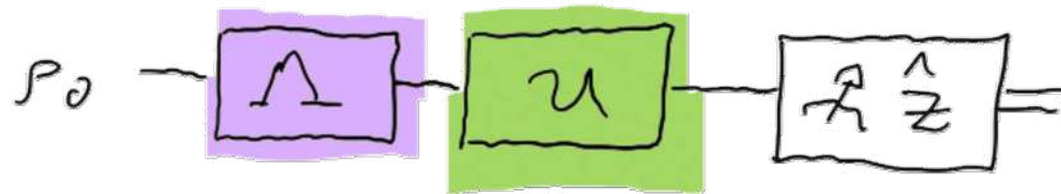


Details on notation:

Quantum register alphabet $\mathcal{Z} = \{0, 1\}$
 Hilbert space $\mathcal{H} = \mathbb{C}^{\mathcal{Z}}$
 Initial state $\rho_0 \in D(\mathcal{H}) \subset L(\mathcal{H})$
 Ideal unitary $U \in U(\mathcal{H}) \subset L(\mathcal{H})$
 Ideal u-channel $\mathcal{U}(\rho) = U \rho U^\dagger$
 $\mathcal{U} \in C(\mathcal{H}) \subset L(L(\mathcal{H}))$



Noisy gate / circuit $\tilde{\mathcal{U}} \in L(L(\mathcal{H}))$



Decompose noisy gate $\tilde{\mathcal{U}} = \mathcal{U} \Lambda$

Blackboard derivation

Simple Example

Keeping it simple and illustrative, let's do a simple case

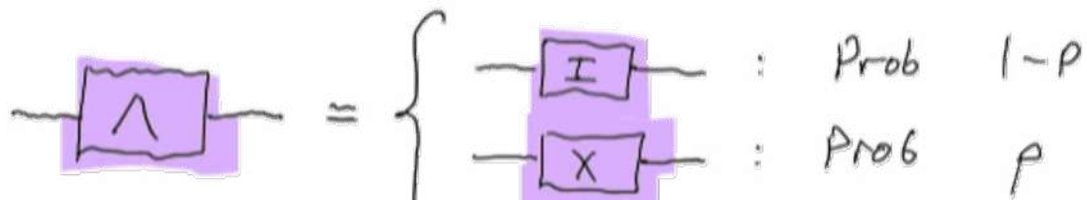
$$\text{Let } U = I \\ u = I \cdot I$$

For the noise, let's play with the simplest bit-flip channel

$$\Lambda_{\mathcal{P}} = \underbrace{(1-p)I_{\mathcal{P}}I}_{\text{prob of no error}} + \underbrace{pX_{\mathcal{P}}X}_{\text{prob of a bit flip error}}$$

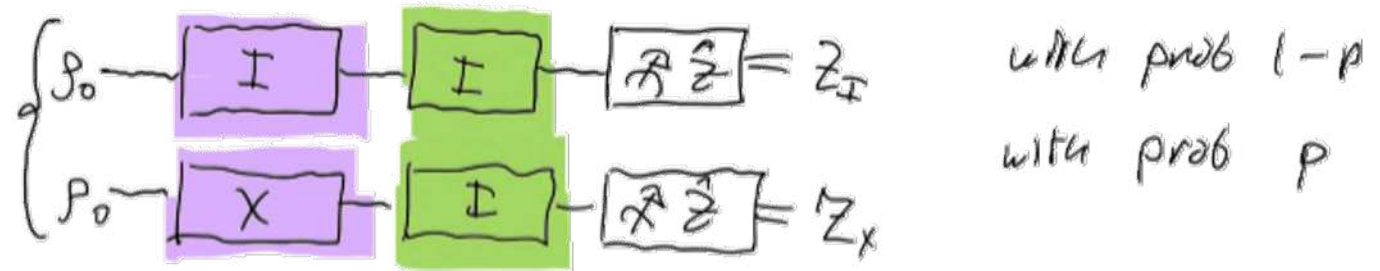
$$\left(\Lambda_{\mathcal{P}} = (1-p)\mathcal{I}_{\mathcal{P}} + p\mathcal{X}_{\mathcal{P}} \right. \quad \left. \begin{array}{l} \text{Equivalent superoperator channel representation} \\ \mathcal{X}_{\mathcal{P}} = X_{\mathcal{P}}X \\ \mathcal{I}_{\mathcal{P}} = I_{\mathcal{P}}I = \mathcal{P} \end{array} \right)$$

Equivalent trajectory unraveling



Blackboard derivation

Our circuit then is equivalent to either



Simple Example

Keeping it simple and illustrative, let's do a simple case

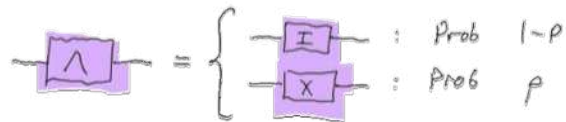
$$\text{Let } U = I \\ \mathcal{U} = I \cdot I$$

For the noise, let's play with the simplest bit-flip channel

$$\mathcal{N}(\rho) = \underbrace{(1-p)}_{\text{prob of no error}} I \rho I + \underbrace{p}_{\text{prob of a bit flip error}} X \rho X$$

$$\left(\begin{aligned} \mathcal{N}_\rho &= (1-p)\mathcal{I}_\rho + p\mathcal{X}_\rho \\ \mathcal{X}_\rho &= X \rho X \\ \mathcal{X}_\rho &= I \rho I = \rho \end{aligned} \right) \quad \begin{array}{l} \text{Equivalent superoperator} \\ \text{channel representation} \end{array}$$

Equivalent trajectory unraveling



The ideal expectation value is

$$\hat{Z}_{\text{ideal}} = \langle \hat{Z} \rangle = \text{Tr}(\hat{Z} \mathcal{I} \rho_0) = \text{Tr}(\hat{Z} \rho_0) = \rho_Z$$

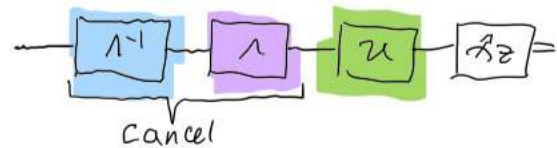
When the channel introduces an error however,

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbb{E}[\hat{Z}_X] &= \text{Tr}(\hat{Z} \mathcal{X}_\rho \mathcal{X}) = \text{Tr}(\mathcal{X} \hat{Z} \mathcal{X} \rho) \\ &= \text{Tr}(-\hat{Z} \rho) \\ &= -\rho_Z \end{aligned}$$

Blackboard derivation

Noise Inverse

To undo the noise, we'd like to introduce the inverse noise

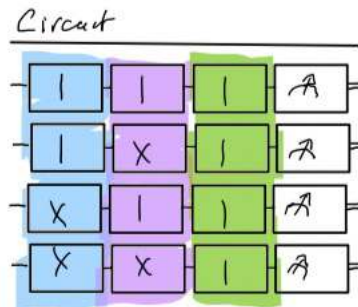


$$\Lambda^{-1}\Lambda = \Lambda\Lambda^{-1} = \mathbb{I}$$

Taking the ansatz $\Lambda^{-1}(p) = (1-r)\mathbb{I} \cdot \mathbb{I} + r(X \cdot X)$

we see 4 cases of unraveling

inverse	noise	no error	prob
I	I	✓	$(1-r)(1-p)$
I	X	✗	$(1-r)p$
X	I	✗	$r(1-p)$
X	X	✓	rp



ideally, we want to interfere trajectories so that the no-error ones will coherently add to unity probably, and the ones with an error will cancel.

$$\therefore \textcircled{A} (1-r)(1-p) + r \cdot p = 1 \quad \wedge \quad \textcircled{B} (1-r)p + r(1-p) = 0$$

$$1 - r - p + 2rp = 1$$

$$r + p - 2rp = 0$$

$$p + r - 2rp = 0$$

same condition

$$\Rightarrow r(1-2p) = -p$$

$\therefore$

$$r = \frac{-p}{1-2p}$$

Recall p is a probability $0 \leq p \leq 1$,

$$p=0 \Rightarrow r=0$$

$$p=1 \Rightarrow r=1$$

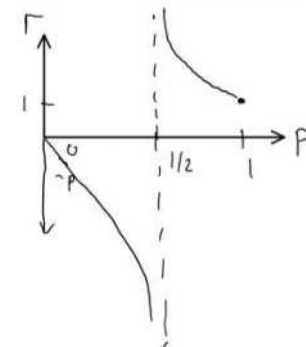
$$p=1/2 \Rightarrow r=\infty$$

$$p \ll 1 \Rightarrow r \approx -p$$

no noise, no need to do anything

deterministic bit-flip, requires deterministic bit flip usually for Λ^{-1}

singular value, since at $p=1/2$, we hit 0, scramble the state



Blackboard derivation

Note that we could equivalently have used the algebraic condition and solved for r

$$\Lambda(\Lambda^{-1}(\rho)) = \mathcal{I}(\rho) = \rho \quad \text{Solve for } r$$

$$= \Lambda((1-r)\rho + rX\rho X)$$

$$= \underbrace{(1-p)(1-r)\rho + prX\rho X}_{\text{no error}} + \underbrace{(1-p)rX\rho X + (1-r)pX\rho X}_{\text{error}}$$

$$= \underbrace{[(1-p)(1-r) + pr]\rho}_{\text{no error}} + \underbrace{[(1-p)r + (1-r)p]X\rho X}_{\text{error}}$$

Same conditions as above! solution $r = \frac{p}{1-2p}$

Blackboard derivation

How to implement? Quasi-Probability

$$\begin{aligned}\Lambda^{-1} &= (1-r)I_Z I_Z + r X_Z X_Z & r &= \frac{-p}{1-2p} \\ &= \left[\frac{|1-r|}{|1-r|+|r|} \operatorname{sgn}(1-r) I_Z I_Z + \frac{|r|}{|1-r|+|r|} \operatorname{sgn}(r) X_Z X_Z \right] (|1-r|+|r|) \\ &= \gamma \left[S_I P_I I_Z I_Z + S_X P_X X_Z X_Z \right]\end{aligned}$$

with

$$\gamma = |1-r| + |r|$$

$$P_I = \frac{|1-r|}{\gamma} \quad S_I = \operatorname{sgn}(1-r)$$

$$P_X = \frac{|r|}{\gamma} \quad S_X = \operatorname{sgn}(r)$$

valid prob distribution

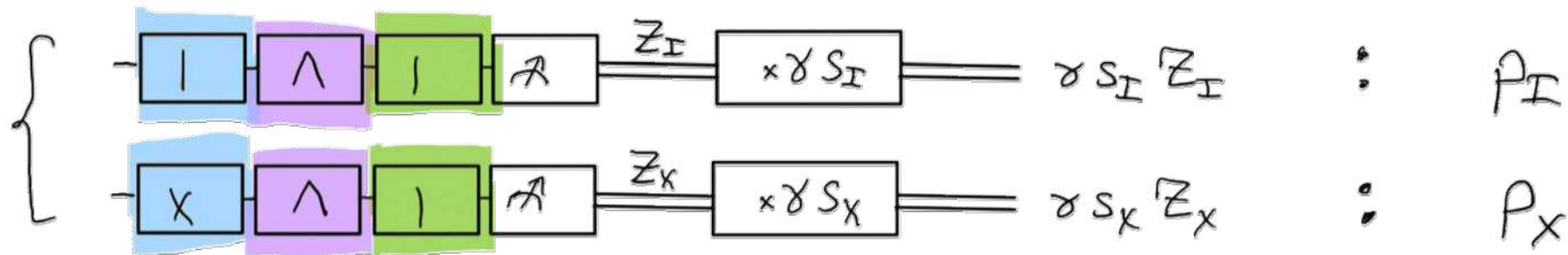
$$0 \leq P_I, P_X \leq 1 \quad \text{and} \quad |P_I| + |P_X| = 1$$

Blackboard

How to sample?

$$\begin{aligned}
 \langle Z \rangle &= \text{Tr}(Z \Lambda \Lambda^{-1} \rho_0) \\
 &= \text{Tr}(Z \tilde{I} [\gamma S_I \rho_I \tilde{I}^\dagger + \gamma S_X \rho_X \tilde{I}^\dagger X]) \\
 &= \gamma S_I \rho_I \text{Tr}(Z \tilde{I} \rho_0) + \gamma S_X \rho_X \text{Tr}(Z \tilde{I} X \rho_0) \\
 &= \gamma \left[S_I \rho_I \underbrace{\langle Z \rangle_I}_{\substack{\text{quantum} \\ \text{circuit exp. val use can find}}} + S_X \rho_X \underbrace{\langle Z \rangle_X}_{\leftarrow} \right]
 \end{aligned}$$

Equivalent interpretation:



Blackboard

Estimator

$$E_{\text{mitg}} = \gamma S_I Z_I + \gamma S_X Z_X$$

$$\mathbb{E}[E_{\text{mitg}}] = \langle \hat{Z} \rangle_{\text{ideal}}$$

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbb{V}[E_{\text{mitg}}] &= \mathbb{V}[\gamma S_I Z_I] + \mathbb{V}[\gamma S_X Z_X] \\ &= \gamma^2 \mathbb{V}[Z_I] + \gamma^2 \mathbb{V}[Z_X] \\ &= \gamma^2 (2 \sigma_{\text{ideal}}^2) \end{aligned}$$

$$\sigma_{\text{ideal}}^2 = \mathbb{V}[Z_I] = 4q(1-q)$$

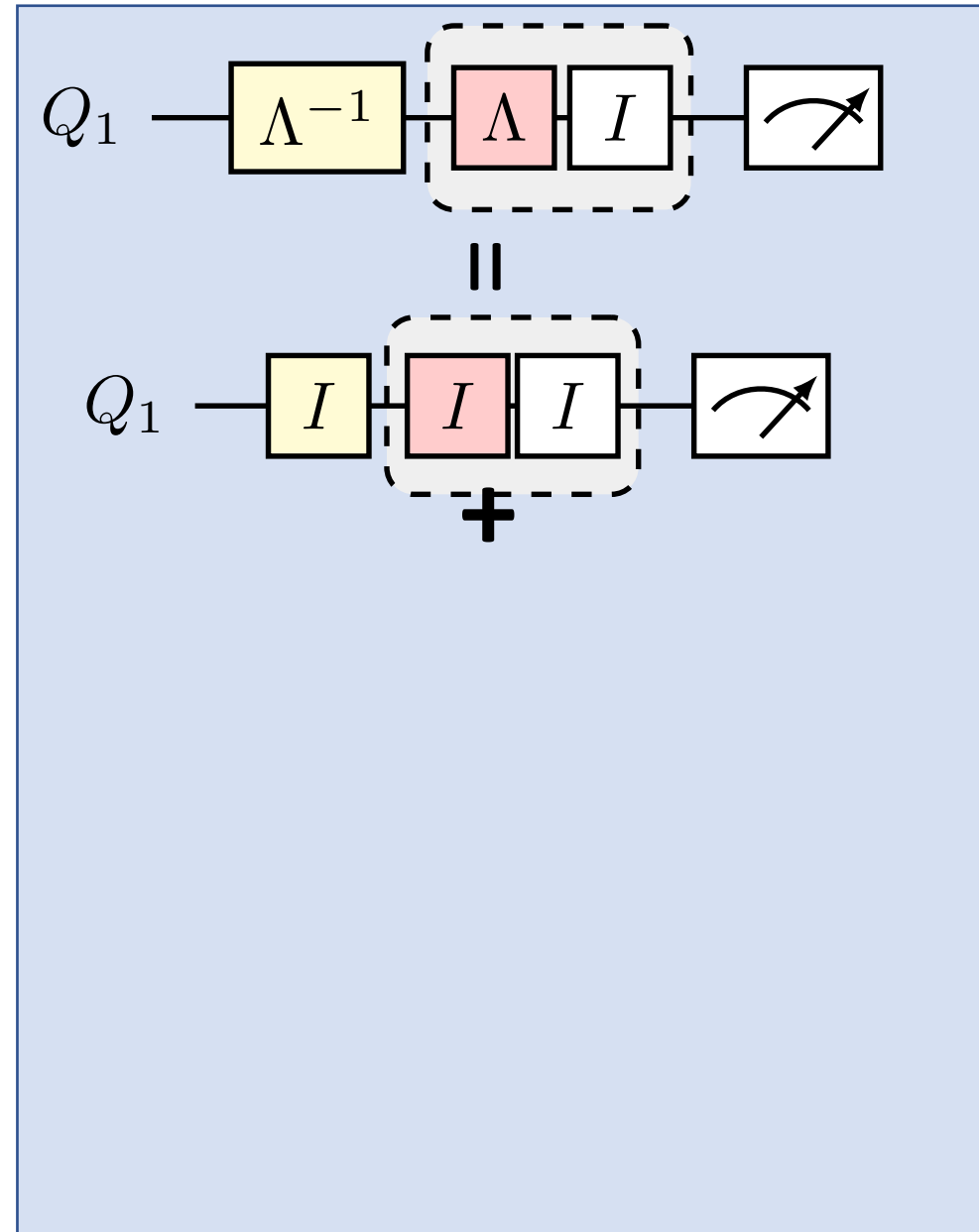
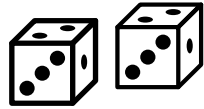
$$q = 1 - 2P_Z = \langle \frac{1 - \hat{Z}}{2} \rangle$$

Since the X just flips $Z \rightarrow -Z$ of P , it follows that the variance is the same, since symmetric

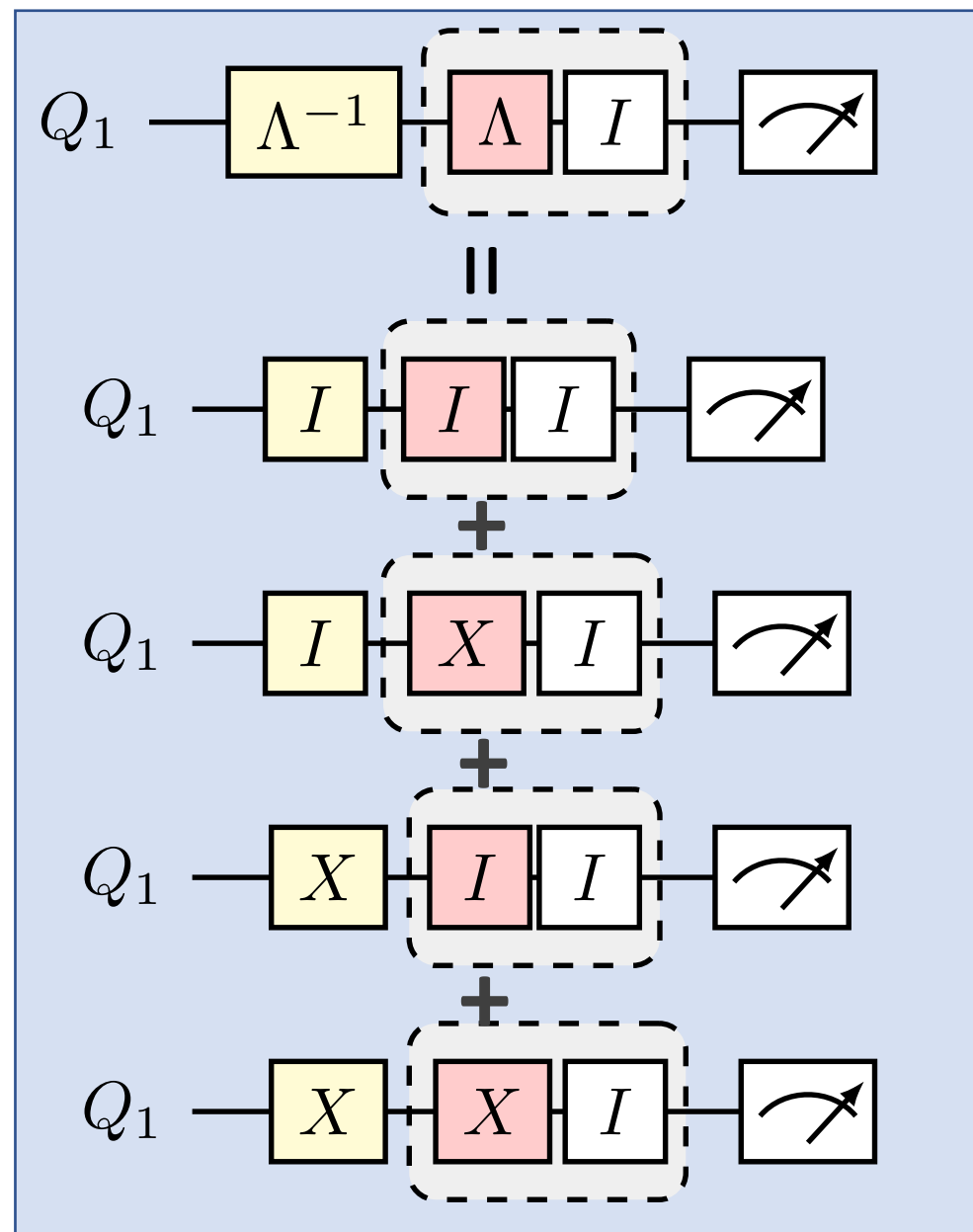
Raveling quantum trajectories to undo noise

No error

probability
 $(1-q)(1-p)$

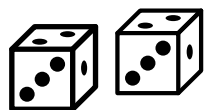


Raveling quantum trajectories to undo noise



No error

probability
 $(1-q)(1-p)$



ERROR!

$(1-q)p$

ERROR!

$q(1-p)$

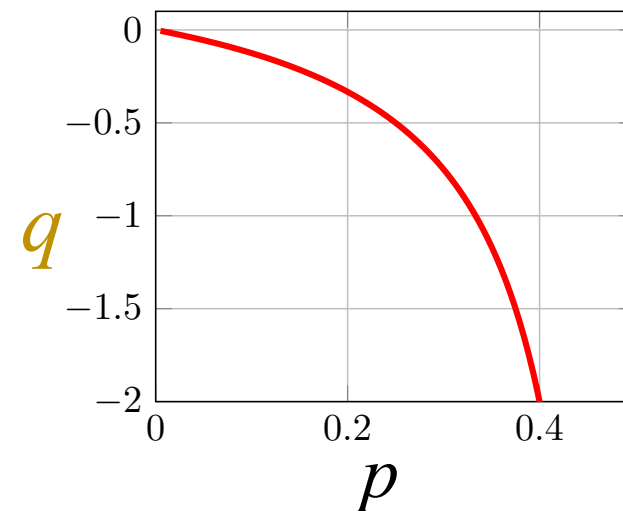
Error
CANCELED!

qp

Solution to noise free!

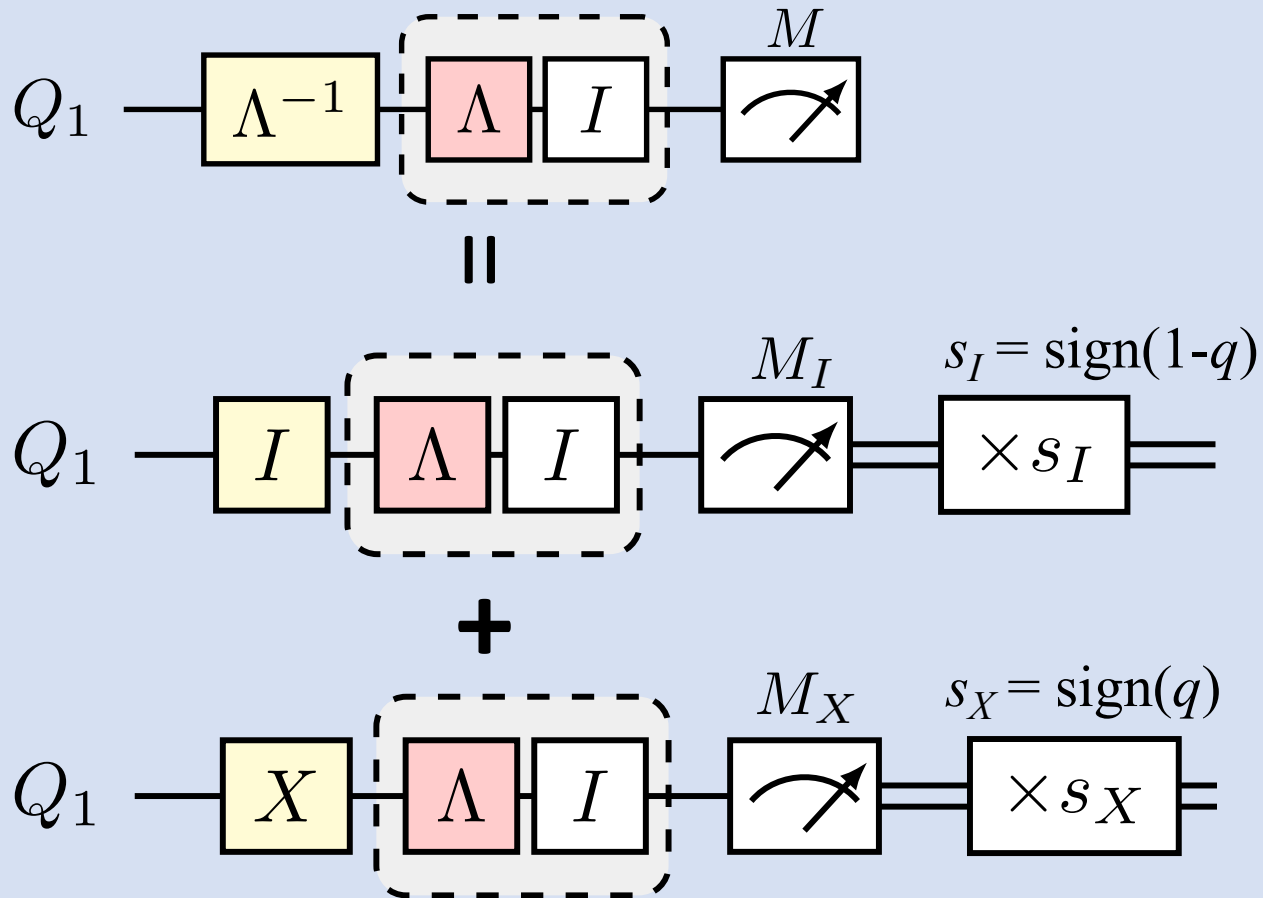
$$q = \frac{-p}{1 - 2p}$$

Sign & scale:
quasi-probability



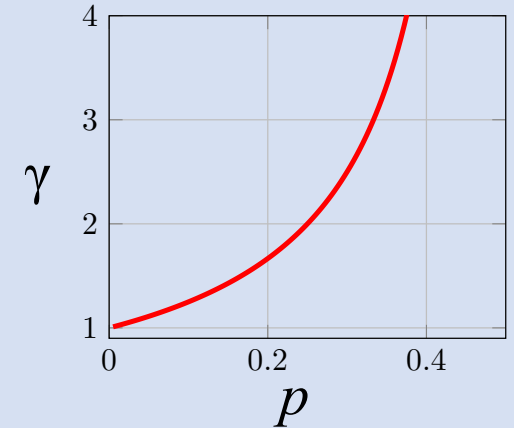
How to implement?

random circuits
(quantum trajectories)



sampling overhead

$$\gamma = |1-q| + |q|$$



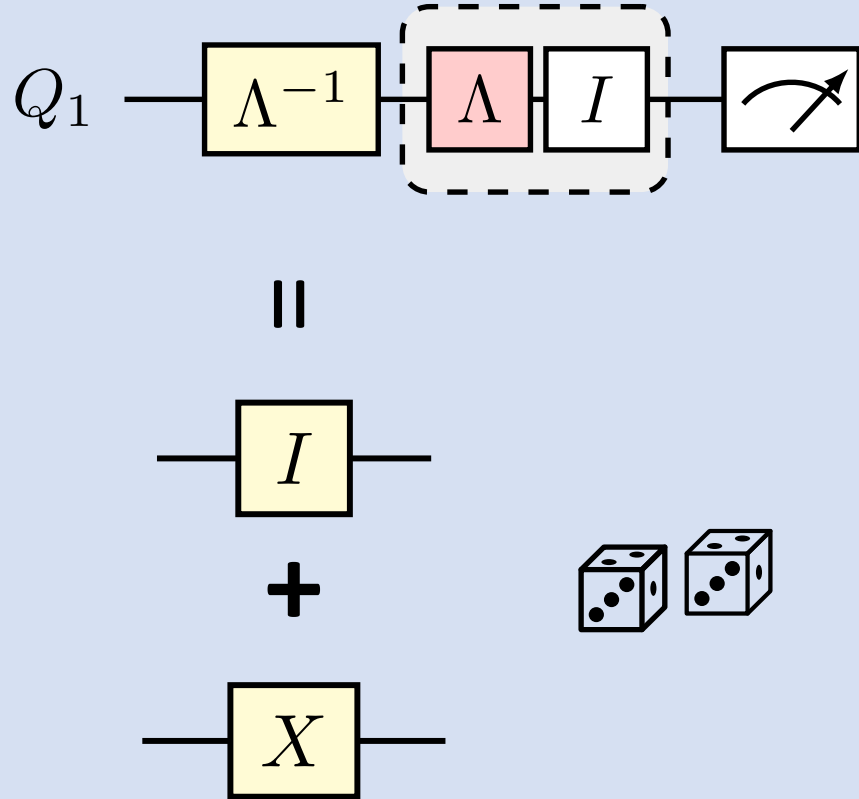
mitigated expectation

$$\langle M \rangle = \gamma (s_I P_I M_I + s_X P_X M_X)$$

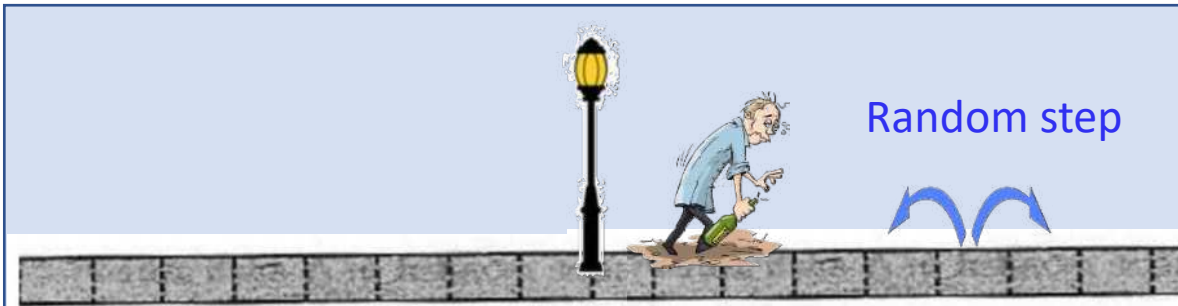
Gain: Bias-free estimate!

Cost: Variance

Canceling noise with noise



Canceling noise with noise: Drunkard's classical random walk analogy

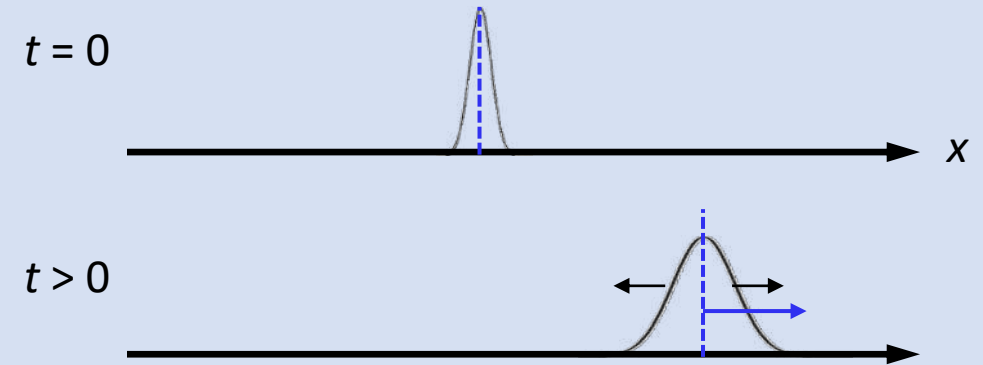


Random step

$$P(1 \text{ step left}) = \frac{1}{2} - p$$

$$P(1 \text{ step right}) = \frac{1}{2} + p$$

Distribution of random walk

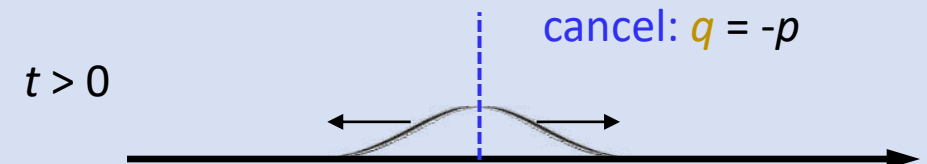


add 2nd random process
wind blows

$$P(1 \text{ step left}) = \frac{1}{2} + q$$

$$P(1 \text{ step right}) = \frac{1}{2} - q$$

Distribution of random walk with wind



Gain: Bias-free estimate!

Cost: Variance

Quantum Noise and Error Mitigation

Lecture 1

Big picture

Quantum computers status

Why error mitigation?

Noise in quantum computers
Overview of error mitigation

Mitigation fundamentals

Probabilistic error cancelation (PEC)

Introduction
One qubit example

Next lecture

Learning noise
State-of-art mitigation experiments
Hardware
Outlook

